

Ruminant Farm System Model

Manure Module

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I. Preface: A Day in the Life on a RuFaS Farm

This document provides a high-level overview of the daily operations of a ruminant farm, as modeled by RuFaS. The overview will be through the eyes of Dr. Rue Fas. One day, Dr. Rue woke up and decided the life of a computer scientist wasn't for her. So she bought a dairy farm, and this is how she operates it every day.

Feeding the Animals Second thing in the morning, after coffee, Dr. Rue checks the calendar to see if it's time to formulate a new ration for her animals.

If a new ration needs to be formulated, Dr. Rue heads over to the barn where she keeps all her forages and feed. While there, she checks how well all the forages are holding up. After considering the feeds available, the quality of each one, and how much each one costs, she decides on how productive she wants her animals to be. It is a difficult balancing act, but eventually a ration recipe is found that will keep the animals happy while keeping costs low and sustainability high until the calendar says the ration recipe needs to be reformulated.

When Dr. Rue doesn't need to formulate a new ration, she takes the last ration recipe she made and grabs all the feed and forage the animals need for the day out of the feed barn. If there isn't enough for the animals, then a new ration is formulated using the steps above.

Taking Care of the Animals After making sure all the animals' feed is taken care of, Dr. Rue moves on to taking care of all the other animal tasks. This includes milking the animals, making sure they're healthy, getting them pregnant, and numerous other tasks.

As dawn breaks on the RuFaS farm, the animals awaken after a restful night. Joe, the farm master, prepares a large whiteboard to track HerdReproductionStatistics, ensuring he has all the data he needs for the day's activities.

Daily Routine - After leaving their pens, each animal lines up in front of the barn. Julie, the diligent farm veterinarian, examines them one by one. This daily check includes updates on the following areas:

- **Nutrients:** Each animal begins its day with a quick phosphorus requirement assessment. Julie records these details and updates the animal's phosphorus-related metrics.
- **Digestive System:** With nutrient information in hand, Julie shifts focus to each animal's digestive system, estimating manure output and enteric methane production for that day.
- **Milk Production:** All milking cows are assessed to gauge daily milk yield and milk component content (fat and protein). Any necessary adjustments are noted.
- **Animal Growth:** Around midday, Julie returns to each animal to evaluate daily weight changes. She updates each animal's body weight accordingly.
- **Reproduction:** HeiferII and Cow stage animals undergo a reproduction check. Julie closely monitors their reproductive progress and updates the HerdReproductionStatistics details on Joe's whiteboard.
- **Life Stage Evaluation:** Once the daily routines are complete, Julie determines if any animal is ready to progress to the next life stage. Graduating animals are marked as "graduated" to be moved to their new pens. Animals that must leave the herd—due to health, productivity, or other issues—are labeled as "sold" or "dead" to be removed from the farm population.
- **Herd Size Maintenance:** After every animal has been evaluated, Joe counts the herd to ensure it remains at a healthy size. If it is too large, he arranges the sale of some animals. If the herd is too small, he may opt to purchase additional heiferIIIs to keep numbers at the ideal level.
- **Herd Structure Management:** Joe also manages pen assignments. Newly graduated or newborn animals are guided to suitable pens, while animals marked for removal (sold or deceased) are taken out of the herd and removed from the farm records.



Output Reporting At day's end, Joe and Julie review the updated HerdReproductionStatistics on the white-board. Joe then compiles a concise report summarizing the day's herd stats. He forwards this information to the OutputManager before wrapping up another successful day on the RuFaS farm.

Dealing with the Manure Once all the animal chores are finished, Dr. Rue moves on to handling the manure. There are a lot of different ways that manure is collected from the animals: it is flushed out of the milking parlor with water, some of the pens need to have it shoveled out along with the bedding in the pen, and some pens have grates that allow the manure to go straight into a pit beneath the barn.

There are a lot of different places where manure is processed and stored on the farm. Dr. Rue goes from place to place on the farm, moving the manure from one place to the next. The manure chores are finished after moving all of the manure into her lagoons, compost piles, and other storages. As this final manure chore is completed, she writes down all the information about how much manure is in all these storages, and some information about what that manure is made of. How much water, nitrogen, phosphorus, other solids, etc. are in each storage.

Managing the Fields Now that Dr. Rue is done making sure all the manure has been handled and stored properly, she can take care of all the field tasks. She has a lot of fields on her farm, each with its own unique schedule. Her field management routine starts with checking each field's schedule to see if any of them are due to have manure applied, and if so, how much they should have applied. After noting all the manure that is supposed to go onto her fields, these amounts are checked against the amounts of manure that are in her manure storage. Dr. Rue then applies manure to each field on the schedule that day, trying to match the amount applied to the amount on the schedule as best she can.

After making sure every manure item on each farm's schedule has been taken care of for the day, the schedule for each field is rechecked, one field at a time. In each schedule she checks to see if that field needs to be tilled, if any chemical fertilizer needs to be applied, and if any crops need to be planted or harvested. After all these activities are taken care of, Mother Nature goes to work. The sun shines and rain falls, providing the field with water and energy that grows crops and soaks the soil. After taking care of each field one by one, Dr. Rue drives back to the main farm with all of the crops that she harvested on that day.

Storing the Feeds Now that she is back at the barns, all the crops that were just harvested can be stored. Fortunately she is very organized, so all her harvested crops are separate from one another and each has a label, indicating where it will be stored inside the feed barn. As each feed is stored, it is labeled with the current date. Dr. Rue is exhausted from another long day. She goes back to the farmhouse and rests up, preparing to do the whole thing over again tomorrow. Her daily routine might seem repetitive, but each day is a crucial part of the larger, continuous process that keeps her farm running efficiently and sustainably.

II. Module Introduction

The responsibility of the manure module in RuFaS is to simulate the loss and/or gain of manure mass and nutrients on a daily timestep at each step of the manure management chain on a dairy farm. On the majority of farms, manure represents an important link in the cycling of nutrients through animals, land, crops, and back to animals. Therefore, modeling both greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions as well as non-GHG nutrient and losses is crucial in capturing nutrient flows through the whole-farm system.

The manure module accomplishes its responsibilities by tracking a critical, core set of variables called "ManureStream" variables, which include key agronomic nutrients (N, P, K), carbon (e.g. total and volatile solids), water, ash, mass, and volume. The Manure Module receives manure excretion and bedding information from the animal module, then passes manure through the manure management chain, until manure is either applied to fields or exported. The specific steps of the manure management chain are user-defined, and the individual steps/options in manure management chains are referred to as "processors". The exact chemical, physical, or other processes that occur at each step along the management chain depend on what type of processor the manure is being held in. For example, parlor cleaning processors, which represent removing manure from the milking parlor and holding areas, principally add water to manure but do not estimate GH



emissions or other nutrient losses. A slurry storage outdoor processor (a type of manure storage), however, estimates daily methane (CH_4) and ammonia ($\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$) losses, which are then reflected by reducing the quantity of nutrients remaining in the stored manure at the end of the day.

Structural setup of the Manure Module Processors in the Manure Module fall into four basic classes, with multiple types available within each class. The processor classes are intended to represent the common, primary steps in manure management. They include manure handling (which refers to the daily activities of cleaning and removing manure from facilities or managing it in place), storage, and manure treatment, such as anaerobic digestion or mechanical solid liquid separation.

Table 1: Examples of processor types by class.

Classes	Types
Handler	Manual Scraping; Alley Scraper; Flush System; Parlor Cleaning
Digester	Continuous Mix
Separator	Screw Press; Rotary Screen
Storage	Composting; Open Lot; Bedded Pack; Slurry Storage Outdoor; Slurry Storage Underfloor; Anaerobic Lagoon

How manure moves between processors is based on defining the destination processor that any one processor should send its manure to, and the proportion(s) of manure from the originating processor that should go there. For example, if 50% of manure from a single pen is routed to storage A, and 50% to storage B, the manure handler processor assigned to that pen will have two destinations defined (storage A and storage B), with the proportion going to each defined as 0.50. By controlling destinations and proportions, the user is able to define aggregating (i.e., assigning manure from two separate processors to the same destination) and splitting (assigning manure from one processor to two or more locations) behavior. A visual example is below and illustrates the manure management chain without RuFaS-specific syntax. The next figure illustrates RuFaS-specific information (e.g. specific processor names, creation of manure streams in the animal module, etc.). Note that the splitting of manure generated from singular pens in the Animal Module illustrated in Figure 8 is covered in the Animal to Manure Connection document.

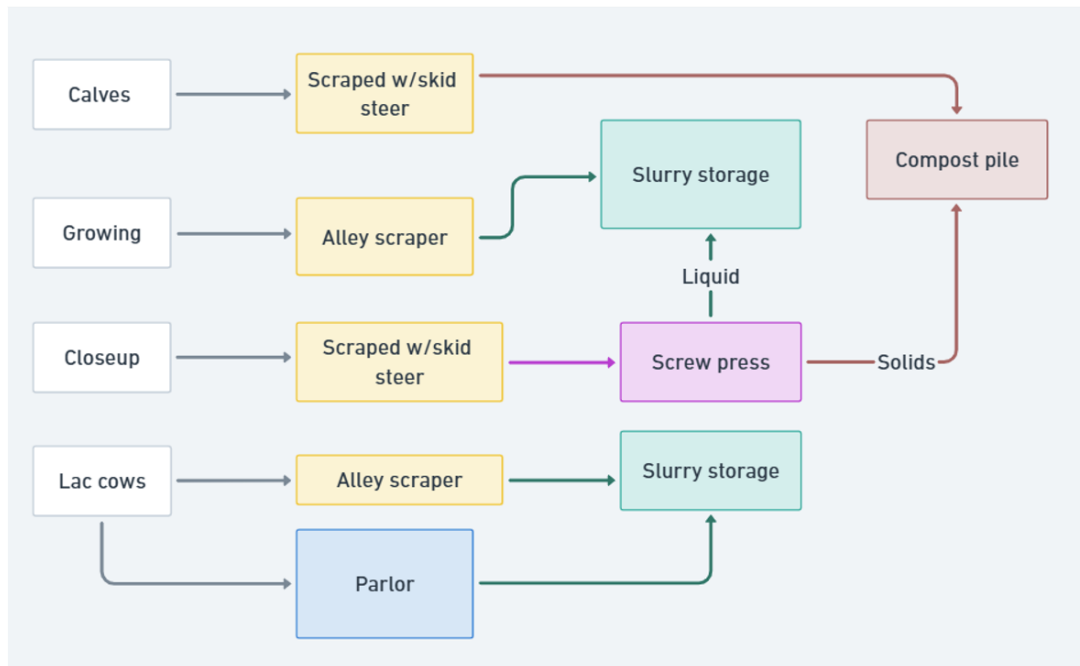


Figure 1: A real-world example of a simplistic manure management chain.

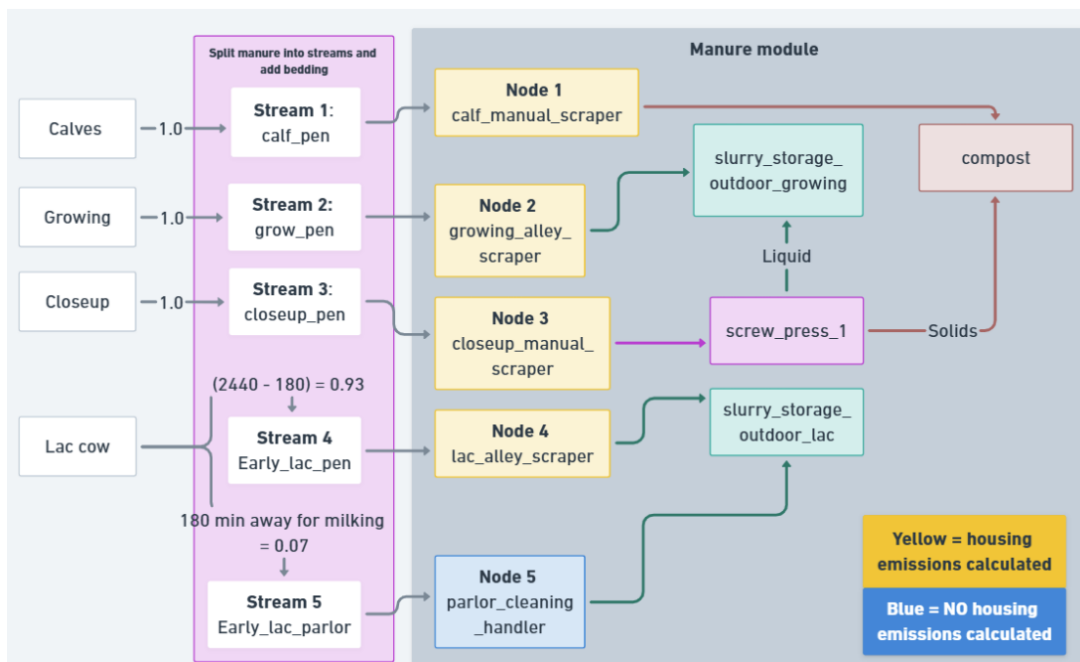


Figure 2: The manure management chain illustrated in the previous figure, with RuFaS-specific information reflected.

Overview of Required Inputs There are two general categories of input required from the user:

1. Which processors are used and how do they work (processor-specific configurations) E.g., storage time length, use of a cover
2. Destination and proportion(s) allocated to destination(s) of manure passed from each processor



Information on inputs required and options available for each individual processor are outlined in the individual processor documentation.

For defining destinations and proportions, there are very few rules and restrictions on how manure can be moved between processors. The primary rule for defining processor destinations is that users cannot define loops, i.e., manure from a processor “downstream” in a manure management chain cannot return its manure to a processor “upstream”.

The assignment of manure generated in the Animal Module (which also reflects the quantity of bedding used) to its destination in the Manure Module occurs in the Animal Module. See the [Animal to Manure Connection](#) section for more information.

General Assumptions of the Manure Module

1. All manure is recovered unless otherwise specifically stated. For example, all manure excreted by animals is assumed to be captured by manure handlers, all manure in a manure storage is assumed to be completely removed when the storage is emptied (unless explicitly noted in the specific processor's documentation), etc.
2. Manure moves through the manure management chain once, and only once, per day. With this, values are reported on a daily timestep, and represent the current state at the end of the given day (e.g. CH₄ emissions from this day, amount of N left in storage on this day, etc.).
 - Storage processors include a user-defined “storage time”, during which manure accumulates in the storage until reaching the end of the time interval, at which point it is passed to the next processor or exported, if the storage comes last in the manure chain. The minimum storage time value is 1, thus manure cannot move through more than one storage per day.
 - For processors without a storage time option, manure is assumed to move through the processor immediately. E.g., on a single day, excreted manure may move through a handler, continuous mix digester, separator, and into composting storage, with each processor reporting the quantity and composition of manure they either passed to the next processor or are holding in storage.
3. The Manure Module adheres to the principle of mass balance, meaning, the quantity of manure nutrients remaining in manure is proportional to the quantity of the nutrient lost through biological or physical processes. The same is true for additions of mass/nutrients.
 - One current exception to this is N loss. N losses are not currently reflected in the total mass of manure; this exception will be addressed and corrected in the near future.

Manure Storage Assumptions

1. Received manure nutrients entering a storage are added to accumulated mass/nutrient quantities prior to calculating gas emissions each day.
2. When the end of the storage's user defined storage time is reached, the accumulated manure in storage is removed completely and entirely, and is passed to the next processor in the chain (e.g., a subsequent storage, field application, etc.).
3. Emptying intervals (in days) are defined by the user in equal lengths at this time, e.g., manure storage can be emptied every 3 months (e.g. in April, July, October, January) but cannot be emptied in April, then 2 months later in June, and then 3 months later in September. However, timing of storage emptying (e.g. April and October emptying vs. May and November emptying) can be set according to the general simulation dates to simulate more realistic manure removal behavior.



III. Animal and Manure Module Connection

A. Introduction

Though animals are typically fed and managed in groups, referred to as pens in RuFaS, manure from a single group of animals may not always remain in or be transported to the same location on the farm. For example, lactating cows who must travel to a milking parlor deposit some proportion of their manure outside of their pen. Or, in open lot systems, manure deposited in the concrete feed alley apron is often removed and managed separately from manure deposited on the lot surface. Additionally, more than one type of bedding may be used in a pen (e.g., no bedding during summer but straw provided in winter), which also eventually becomes part of manure. Considering this, RuFaS accommodates routing of manure from a single group (pen) of animals to multiple locations, which are then received by the Manure module. This document describes how a pen's total manure excretion and bedding are allocated to one or more discrete quantities of manure, referred to as manure streams, and passed to the Manure module. How the user configures this manure routing and bedding options and addition of bedding to manure are also described here.

Implementation in RuFaS

The Animal module is responsible for calculating manure excretion mass and composition based on animal attributes, ration composition and intake, and other factors. The Animal module must then pass this manure on to the Manure module, where manure nutrient gains and losses are quantified through field application or export. The Animal module currently calculates manure excretion at the pen level (i.e., values representative of the total manure from animals in a single pen), and several additional steps must occur before manure information can be sent to the Manure module. These steps include:

- Splitting manure from individual pens into one or more user-defined manure streams
- Repackaging manure information into the form and units utilized by the Manure module
- Applying bedding mass or nutrients to manure streams

The direct connection between Animal module, which captures the animal lifecycle, nutrient intake and excretion, and other factors, and the Manure module is a crucial part of the nutrient cycle in RuFaS.

This document describes how the user defines the partitioning of manure from a single pen of animals into one or more manure streams, and the basic mathematical procedure for generating manure streams from excreted manure. Later it will review the options for and application of bedding to manure streams.

Required User Inputs

Table 2: User inputs for Stream Formation and Bedding sections.

	Variable	Units	Description
Stream Formation	minutes_away_for_milking	minutes	The total time (minutes) per day that animals spend walking to/from the parlor, waiting in holding areas, or being actively milked. For non-lactating animals, this value may be omitted or entered as "null".
	first_parlor_processor	–	The name of the processor defined in the Manure module inputs that manure from the milking parlor should enter.
	parlor_stream_name	–	The user-defined name of this pen's parlor stream.
	stream_name	–	The user-defined name of this stream.
	bedding_name	–	The name of the specific bedding configuration used with this stream. See section 2 for more information.

Continued on next page



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	Variable	Units	Description
	stream_proportion	0–1	The proportion of daily manure excreted outside of the parlor and while traveling to/from the parlor that enters this stream. All stream proportions within a pen must sum to 1.0. Optional if only one stream.
	first_processor	–	The name of the processor defined in the Manure module inputs that this ManureStream should enter.
Bedding	name	–	Unique identifier to reference this bedding configuration.
	bedding_type	–	The type of bedding material. Options: sand, straw, sawdust, manure solids, or none.
	bedding_mass_per_day	kg/day	Daily mass of fresh bedding added per animal per day (wet weight). Bedding mass is applied based on the total number of animals in the pen, and is not based on the stream proportion of the manure stream the bedding is assigned to.
	bedding_density	kg/m ³	Density of the bedding on a wet weight basis.
	bedding_dry_matter_content	fraction	Bedding dry matter content as a fraction of total mass.
	bedding_carbon_fraction	fraction	Bedding carbon content as a fraction of total mass.
	bedding_phosphorus_content	fraction	Bedding phosphorus content as a fraction of total mass.
	sand_removal_efficiency	fraction	Fraction of sand assumed to be removed immediately after manure removal.



Other inputs

Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

Stream Formation

- Instances of PenManure objects that represent manure excreted by single pens of animals in the Animal module. See the Manure Excretion section of the Animal Module documentation for further details.
- Instances of Pen objects that represent pen information for single pens of animals in the Animal module.

Bedding Classes

Table 3: List of Python classes for Animal to Manure Module connection.

Handlers	Description
Pen	pen.py; Translates pen-level manure information into the format and units required by the Manure module; Translates pen-level manure information into one or more ManureStream instance(s), if applicable, and creates accompanying PenManureData instances
PenManureData	animal_to_manure_connection.py; Generates PenManureData and ManureStream

Expected Outputs

Stream Formation

- A ManureStream class instance for each manure stream defined by the user, that represents the attributes of the manure in the specific manure stream. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³):
 - water
 - ammoniacal_nitrogen
 - nitrogen
 - phosphorus
 - potassium
 - ash
 - non_degradable_volatile_solids
 - degradable_volatile_solids
 - total_solids
 - mass (equal to sum of water and total solids)
 - total volatile solids (equal to sum of degradable and non-degradable volatile solids)
 - volume
- A PenManureData class instance for each manure stream defined by the user, that represents the attributes of the animals and pen from which the manure originated. PenManureData instances include the following variables, reported by the Animal module:
 - num_animals: number of animals present in the pen from which the manure stream originated. Note that this variable does not correspond to the number of animals that generated the manure contained in the stream.



- `manure_deposition_surface_area`: the surface area soiled with manure, used in the determination of housing emissions. See the Manure Handler document for information on determination of this value (MN.HDL.4).
- `animal_combination`: the type of animal contained in the pen (calf, growing, closeup, or lactating).
- `pen_type`: the type of pen (freestall, tiestall, open lot, or bedded pack barn) the manure in this stream originated from.
- `manure_urine_mass` (kg): mass of urine in the manure.
- `manure_urine_nitrogen` (kg): mass of urine N in the manure.
- `stream_type`: the type of ManureStream (parlor stream or general stream).
- `first_processor`: the name of the processor defined in the Manure module inputs that this ManureStream should enter.
- `total_bedding_mass` (kg): the total mass of bedding added to this stream.
- `total_bedding_volume` (m³): the total volume of bedding added to this stream.

Bedding

- `total_bedding_mass`: The total mass of bedding added to the ManureStream each day (kg).
- `total_bedding_volume`: The total mass of bedding added to the ManureStream each day (kg).

B. Methodology

Stream Formation

How many discrete locations/quantities (i.e., manure streams) a single pen's manure is split into is determined by the user. There are two types of manure streams in the model:

Parlor: A stream representing manure deposited in or while traveling to/from the milking parlor, along with (fresh, non-recycled) wash water.

- A parlor stream is not directly defined by the user for each pen in the way general streams are; parlor streams are created automatically for each lactating pen. The user specifies the proportion of each lactating pen's total manure that enters the parlor stream via the minutes away for milking input. Time away from the pen for milking can vary greatly between farms but also is typically known by the farm management, as fetching and pushing cows to the parlor is an intentional daily activity. This makes time away from the pen for milking (`minutes_away_for_milking`) a simple and relatively reliable metric for determining the basic split of manure in the housing area vs. milking parlor.
- Only one parlor stream can be created per lactating cow pen. However, more than one milking parlor (destination for milking parlor manure) may be defined for a farm; the user simply assigns parlor streams to differing instances of a parlor cleaning handler, which represents the milking parlor. See Manure Handler documentation for more information.
- No bedding can be applied to parlor streams.

General: A stream representing all or a portion of non-parlor manure and bedding. Manure in this stream or streams represents manure excreted outside the milking parlor or traveling to/from the parlor.

- All pens must have at least one general stream defined.
- Theoretically, an infinite number of general streams can be defined per pen, as long as stream proportions are provided for all of them. However, most practical farm simulation scenarios will require only one or two general manure streams per pen.
- The number of general streams and the proportion of non-parlor manure entering each stream is directly defined by the user. Stream proportion logic is covered below.



General-type manure streams are defined in the animal inputs, within each Pen blob. Each pen includes a “manure_streams” array input in which the user defines the one or more general manure streams generated by this specific pen. The required inputs and their definitions are described above in the Inputs section; these inputs must be provided for each manure stream as outlined in the figure below.

```
"manure_streams": [  
  {  
    "stream_name": "lac_exercise_lot",  
    "bedding_name": "no_bedding",  
    "stream_proportion": 0.25,  
    "first_processor": "lac_alley_scraper"  
  },  
  {  
    "stream_name": "lac_bedded_pen",  
    "bedding_name": "lac_and_growing_sand",  
    "stream_proportion": 0.75,  
    "first_processor": "lac_bedded_pack"  
  }  
]
```

Figure 3: If manure from a pen is routed to two different general manure streams, two sets of manure stream inputs must be defined. An example of a single pen's manure stream inputs is above - in this example, manure from this pen is routed to two locations, one representing an exercise lot, the other representing a bedded pack area.

Stream proportion logic

The stream proportion refers to the user-defined proportion (0 to 1) of manure generated by animals in a single pen that enters a specific manure stream. The translation of user-defined stream proportions into the effective stream proportion utilized by the model is described below. This effective proportion is referred to as the split ratio in the model code - it is the value by which total manure excretions are multiplied by to determine the quantity of any single nutrient allocated to a stream of any type (e.g., 20% (0.20) to parlor stream, 40% (0.40) to general stream 1, 40% (0.40) to general stream 2. The values are the split ratios).

Non-lactating pens If more than one general stream is defined for a single pen, a stream proportion must be provided for each stream, and manure will be allocated to streams according to these proportions. Essentially, the split ratio is equal to the user-defined stream proportion.

Lactating pens

Parlor streams: The user-defined minutes away for milking is used to calculate the stream proportion value for the milking parlor:

When:

$$\text{parlor_stream_proportion} = \frac{\text{minutes_away_for_milking}}{1440}$$

[AN.PEN.1]

- minutes_away_for_milking: user-defined total minutes per day lactating cows spend out of the pen traveling to/from the parlor or being milked.
- 1440: minutes per day.



General streams Each general stream proportion represents the fraction of manure—excluding that deposited in or during travel to/from the milking parlor—that enters a specific manure stream. For example, if all manure outside the parlor enters one stream, its proportion would be 1.0. If manure outside the parlor was split evenly between two general streams, each stream's proportion would be 0.50. With this, the effective proportion of total manure entering this stream (the split ratio) must be calculated according to the parlor stream proportion. First, we determine the proportion of manure entering any and all general streams vs. the parlor stream.

$$total_general_stream_portion = 1 - parlor_stream_proportion$$

[AN.PEN.2]

When:

- `parlor_stream_proportion`: proportion of total manure allocated to the parlor stream, calculated in [AN.PEN.1].

Once we have derived the proportion of manure entering any/all general streams, we multiply this proportion by the user-defined general stream proportion(s), to determine the split ratio for each general stream.

$$general_stream_proportion = total_general_stream_proportion * stream_proportion$$

[AN.PEN.3]

To continue with our example from above, if cows spent 200 minutes per day in the milking parlor, their split ratios would be as follows:

Parlor:

$$\frac{200}{1440} = 0.140$$

$$lac_exercise_lot : (1 - 0.139) * 0.25 = 0.215$$

$$lac_bedded_pen : (1 - 0.139) * 0.75 = 0.645$$

Recommended defaults

Although the time away from a pen is highly variable and specific to each farm's infrastructure and management, some recommended defaults for situations where actual information is not available are provided below.

Minutes away for milking

Recommended `minutes_away_for_milking` values for lactating cows are based on cow time budgets from published literature and are not official model defaults. The purpose of these time budgets at the time of writing is strictly related to estimating manure deposition in specific locations and is not related to larger Animal module activities. The use of time budgets for this purpose relies on the assumption that cows excrete urine and feces at a constant rate throughout the day and across various locations.

Open lot and bedded pack systems

The management of open lot and bedded pack barn pens often results in manure from a single pen being managed in multiple ways. These types of pens often have designated resting areas (i.e. the harrowed lot or bedded pack) where manure is managed in place for an extended period, as well as a separate feeding area, such as a concrete apron along a feed alley. Manure deposited in this area may be scraped back into the resting area, or it may be flushed, vacuumed or scraped to another separate storage area. Two distinct manure management routines within a single pen indicate that two manure streams should likely be used. If this is the case, the user may reference the tables below as a starting point for defining stream proportions representing the resting vs. feeding area. Defining two separate manure streams is recommended where



Table 4: Recommended minutes_away_for_milking by pen type based on published literature. Remember, this does not necessarily reflect the model defaults.

Pen Type	minutes_away_for_milking	Proportion	Special Notes
Freestall ¹	200 m (3.33 h)	0.139	
Tiestall	200 m (3.33 h)	0.139	Limited data; value is based on the assumption that daily time away from pen for milking will be broadly similar between freestall and tiestall barns. ²
Open lot	300 m (5 h)	0.208	Assumption that open lot pens tend to be considerably larger than indoor-housed systems (greater travel distance). ³
Compost bedded pack barn	200 m (3.33 h)	0.139	Limited data; value is based on the assumption that daily time away from pen for milking will be broadly similar between freestall and tiestall barns. ²

¹ Gomez and Cook, 2010, Espejo and Endres, 2007

² Jewell et al., 2019

³ Meyer et al., 2019

appropriate to ensure that manure is not over-allocated to the parlor manure stream (where it does not contribute to housing emission estimations) and bedding is allocated appropriately.

The following streams and proportions are based on literature data and are not official model defaults. They are provided for user informational purposes; they may be used as a starting point to adjust proportions specific to a farm, or can be used for theoretical modeling scenarios.

Table 5: Proportions of different streams for different animal classes.

Pen Type	Animal Class	Lactating	Closeup	Growing	Calves
Open lot or bedded pack barn ¹	General stream, lot	0.796	0.76	0.76	1
	General stream, feed alley	0.204	0.24	0.24	N/A
	minutes_away_for_milking	300	N/A	N/A	N/A
Bedded pack barn ²	General stream, bedded pack	0.792	0.819	0.819	1
	General stream, feed alley	0.208	0.179	0.179	N/A
	minutes_away_for_milking	200	N/A	N/A	N/A

¹ Based on data from Meyer et al., 2019 and the assumption that open lot pens tend to be considerably larger than indoor-housed systems (greater travel distance).

² Based on data from Endres and Barberg, 2007, which suggests behavior of cows in compost bedded pack barns is broadly similar to those in other housing systems. With this, freestall data from Gomez and Cook, 2010 was used, which reported 4.3 hours of feeding time, 3.33 hours away for milking, and the remainder spent in the housing area.

Passing information to the Manure module

Once split ratios have been determined for each manure stream in each pen, Animal module manure and pen data can be translated into ManureStream objects. The variables contained in ManureStream are below; this dataclass is used both to move information from Animal to Manure module, as well as move information between processors within the Manure module.

The majority of the variables are calculated in the Animal module and translated directly into a ManureStream object. Subbullets below a variable indicate how variables not directly reported by the Animal module are calculated.

**Bedding**

Bedding is assigned and applied by manure stream, not by pen. The following calculations described how bedding mass, nutrients, and volume are calculated, and how bedding is added to a manure stream.

Calculate total bedding mass

calc_total_bedding_mass

$$total_bedding_mass(kg) = bedding_mass_per_day(kg/animal) * num_animals * sand_removal_efficiency$$

[AN.PEN.7]

When:

- bedding_mass_per_day: The user-inputted bedding mass applied per animal per day. Note that this input is per total number of animals housed in the pen.
- num_animals: Animals in the pen from which the manure stream originated.
- sand_removal_efficiency: User-defined proportion of sand bedding removed via sand settling lane or other sand recovery technology. This value is only utilized if bedding type sand.

Calculate total bedding volume

calc_total_bedding_volume

$$total_bedding_volume(m^3) = \frac{total_bedding_mass(kg)}{bedding_density(kg/m^3)}$$

[AN.PEN.8]

When:

- total_bedding_mass (kg): the total mass of bedding applied to the manure stream each day, calculated in [MN.PEN.7].
- bedding_density (kg/m³): user-defined density of the specified bedding.

Calculate total bedding dry solids

calc_total_bedding_dry_solids

$$total_bedding_dry_solids(kg) = total_bedding_mass(kg) * bedding_dry_matter_content$$

[AN.PEN.9]

When:

- total_bedding_mass (kg): the total mass of bedding applied to the manure stream each day, calculated in [MN.PEN.7].
- bedding_dry_matter_content: user-defined dry matter content of the specified bedding.

Calculate total bedding water

calc_total_bedding_water



$$total_bedding_water(kg) = total_bedding_mass(kg) * (1 - bedding_dry_matter_content)$$

[AN.PEN.10]

When:

- `total_bedding_mass` (kg): the total mass of bedding applied to the manure stream each day, calculated in [MN.PEN.7].
- `bedding_dry_matter_content`: user-defined dry matter content of the specified bedding.

Update ManureStream values to reflect bedding

```
_apply_bedding (pen.py)
```

Table 6: Calculated manure and bedding characteristics

Variable	Units	Calculation
water	kg	ManureStream water (kg) + bedding_water (kg)
ash	kg	if bedding type = sand, ash (kg) = total_bedding_mass (kg); otherwise, ash = 0
phosphorus	kg	ManureStream phosphorus + total_bedding_mass (kg) * bedding_phosphorus_content)
non_degradable_volatile_solids	kg	If bedding type = sand, ManureStream non_degradable_volatile_solids (kg); If bedding type is not sand, ManureStream non_degradable_volatile_solids (kg) + total_bedding_dry_solids (kg)
total_solids	kg	ManureStream total_solids (kg) + total_bedding_dry_solids (kg)
volume	m ³	ManureStream volume (m ³) + total_bedding_volume (m ³)

IV. Manure Handler

A. Introduction

Manure handling refers to the method of managing manure in animal living spaces. For some housing/pen types, such as freestalls and tiestalls, this involves removing the manure from barn alleyways, and is usually accomplished using some form of scraping or flushing with water. Flush systems utilize water to remove the manure from alleyways, whereas scrape systems use little or no water. For other housing types like open lots and compost bedded pack barns, tillage or harrowing are commonly used to instead incorporate the manure, urine, bedding (if applicable) and air into the pack and allow it to dry.

The specific manure handler options in the RuFaS model are:

- **Flushing**

Flushing involves using water to carry manure and soiled bedding away from housing areas. A series of pipes and channels direct water to wash the manure into a collection pit. Flushing helps maintain a cleaner environment for animals and reduces the buildup of manure on the floor. Flushing/recirculating may also be used to “lubricate” transport/pumping of manure from under-floor collection pits to the next manure management step. Flushing is commonly performed using recycled water from a solid liquid separator, liquid manure storage, or other liquid collection area, rather than using fresh water.



- **Manual Scraping**

Scraping involves physically removing the manure and soiled bedding using equipment like tractor-mounted scrapers or skid steers, or the manual use of shovels/scrapers, etc. This method is typically used in barns with slatted or solid floors. Regular scraping prevents manure accumulation and provides a clean area for animals.

- **Alley Scraper**

A scraper blade, typically pulled along by a chain or cable, moves slowly down a pen or alleyway on a set schedule several times a day, pushing or pulling manure out of the pen/alley. The function and outcome is similar to manual scraping, but alley scrapers are mechanized and typically operate automatically.

- **Parlor Cleaning**

Parlor cleaning is a RuFaS-specific handler that represents cleaning of manure from milking units, parlor stall floors, and other areas in the milking parlor that require the use of fresh, non-recycled water. Parlor cleaning also can include an optional flush system capability, which functions in the same manner as the flush system described above and is used to wash manure from holding area floors.

Manure handlers in RuFaS have two primary functions: calculate and add cleaning water if used, and calculate indoor housing emissions of CH₄, CO₂, and NH₃ if applicable.

The following are important assumptions made in the manure handler submodules, as well as context on how manure handlers are used in the larger manure management chain:

1. All manure excreted and all bedding applied each day (if applicable) is assumed to be recovered by the manure handler.
2. Manure handlers in RuFaS are intended to be utilized, at this time, with manure deposited in housing areas that is cleaned frequently (e.g., removed daily or every few days), such as indoor barn floors, or concrete feed alleys in open lot or compost bedded pack pens. Handlers should not be used in manure streams where manure resides for a long period of time, such as streams representing an open lot or bedded pack manure pack, that have a designated processor (i.e., Open Lot or Bedded Pack). Users can consider the manure handler functionality to be “built in” to these processors. Defining a handler prior to one of these types of processors will result in double-counting of housing emissions.
3. If a manure handler is used, it must be defined first in the manure management chain. This prevents inappropriate calculation of housing emissions “downstream” when manure is no longer in the animal housing area. Handlers are meant to represent manure handling in animal living spaces; other manure handling/transport systems such as pumps, augers, belts, etc. are not explicitly modeled in RuFaS.



Required User Inputs

Table 7: Required inputs for the Manure Handler (refreshed_manure_management.json)

Variable	Units	Description
Name	none	Unique identifier of the specific handler configuration used.
Type	none	The type (alley scraper, manual scraping, flushing, or parlor scraping) of manure handler.
cleaning_water_use_amount	L/animal/day	The rate of water use (L per animal per day, total of fresh and/or recycled water) by a specified manure handler.
cleaning_water_recycle_fraction	none	The fraction (0.XX) of cleaning water used by a specified handler that is from recycled (not fresh) water sources.
use_parlor_flush	true/false	True/false indication for if a parlor flush (which may be partially or fully recycled water) is used in addition to routine parlor water cleaning with fresh water.

Other inputs Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

- water
- ammoniacal_nitrogen
- nitrogen
- phosphorus
- potassium
- ash
- non_degradable_volatile_solids
- degradable_volatile_solids
- total_solids
- volume

Manure handlers also make use of information contained in the PenManureData subclass. This includes the following information specific to the pen from which the manure was generated:

- num_animals: number of animals in the pen
- animal_combination: type of animals in the pen (calves, growing post-weaning heifers through closeup period), closeup (cows and heifers within user-defined closeup period), or lactating cows)
- Manure deposition surface area (m²): surface area soiled with manure. See section below on determining soiled surface area
- pen_type: the type of pen the manure was generated in (freestall, tiestall, open lot, or bedded pack barn)
- daily_urine (kg): mass of urine in the manure



- `urine_nitrogen` (kg): mass of urine N in the manure
- `stream_type`: the type of manure stream the manure is in (parlor or general stream)

Note that `stream_type` is not a user input, it is automatically assigned. Parlor streams are created automatically and all other streams are assigned “general”.

Classes

Table 8: The classes of handlers that are used in this module.

Handlers	Description
Handler (Processor)	handler.py contains basic methods that are applicable to all handlers
Single StreamHandler (Handler)	single_stream_handler.py contains alley screaper, manual scraping, and flush system-specific methods
ParlorCleaning (Handler)	parlor_cleaning.py contains parlor cleaning-specific methods

Expected Outputs

Instance(s) of a `ManureStream` that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. `ManureStream` instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m^3)

- All handler types
 - `ManureStream` variables
 - `total_cleaning_water_volume` (m^3): total volume of fresh (non-recycled) cleaning water used for, and ultimately added to, a single manure stream on a single simulation day by the manure handler
 - `barn_temperature` ($^{\circ}\text{C}$): ambient temperature in barn
- Alley scraper, manual scraping, flush system:
 - `housing_methane` (kg): daily CH_4 (kg) emitted from manure on barn floors
 - `housing_ammonia_N_emissions`: (kg): daily $\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$ (kg) emitted from manure on barn floors
 - `housing_carbon_dioxide` (kg): daily CO_2 (kg) emitted from manure on barn floors

B. Methodology

Calculate barn temperature

`_determine_barn_temperature`

Air temperature inside barns is, in general, slightly cooler than the outdoors during the day, and slightly-to-considerably warmer than the outdoor temperature overnight, depending on the season. With this, basic bounds were implemented in the determination of barn temperature. These bounds were suggested by manure SMEs and are supported by barn temperature ranges reported in Bucklin et al., 2009 (Florida, upper limit). The lower bound (5°C) suggested by SMEs was based on general industry standards/conditions.

If ambient (outdoor) air temperature $< 5^{\circ}\text{C}$, barn temperature = 5°C

If ambient (outdoor) air temperature $> 5^{\circ}$ & $< 30^{\circ}\text{C}$, barn temperature = air temperature

If ambient (outdoor) air temperature $> 30^{\circ}\text{C}$, barn temperature = 30°C

Calculate cleaning/flushing fresh water addition

`determine_handler_cleaning_water_volume`



The following method calculates the volume of fresh (non-recycled) cleaning water used for, and ultimately added to, a single manure stream on a single simulation day by the manure handler. This method is used in all handler types; however, for parlor cleaning handlers, this method is only utilized if “use_parlor_flush” is entered as true. If no water is used with the handler (user inputted cleaning water use rate = 0), the function will return 0.

$$\text{cleaning_water}(L) = \text{num_animals} * (\text{cleaning_water_use_rate} * (1 - \text{cleaning_water_recycle_fraction}))$$

[MN.HDL.1]

When:

- num_animals: the number of animals in the pen assigned to the handler
- cleaning_water_use_rate (L/animal/d): the user-provided cleaning water use rate for the handler
- cleaning_water_recycle_fraction: the proportion of cleaning water that is from recycled, non-fresh sources

Total fresh water added to manure (L) each day is calculated as follows:

$$\text{total_cleaning_water}(m^3) = \text{cleaning_water}(L) + \text{fresh_water_volume_used_for_milking}(L) * \text{LITERS_TO_CUBIC_METERS} : \text{a constant set to } 0.997 \text{ kg/m}^3$$

[MN.HDL.2]

When:

- LITERS.TO.CUBIC.METERS: a constant set to 0.997 kg/m³

Calculate milking parlor fresh water addition

The following method calculates the volume of fresh water used for, and ultimately added to, a single manure stream on a single simulation day by the manure handler for parlor cleaning/sanitation purposes. This calculation occurs only in the parlor_cleaning handler and water added is considered to be 100% fresh, non-recycled water, as fresh water is required for cleaning of milking units, floors, etc. The following function is implicit (occurs automatically with any manure stream assigned to the parlor cleaning handler type) and is based at this time on a default value fresh water use rate.

$$\text{fresh_water_volume_used_for_milking}(L) = \text{num_animals} * \text{MILKING_FRESH_WATER_USE_RATE}$$

[MN.HDL.3]

When:

- num_animals: the number of animals in the pen assigned to the handler
- MILKING.FRESH.WATER.USE.RATE (30.0 L/animal/d): the default fresh water use rate for cleaning equipment/floors in the milking parlor

Calculate housing emissions

The calculation of housing emissions according to the methods described below is applicable only to areas where manure resides for short periods of time, i.e., tiestall and freestall housing systems, or, in open lot or bedded pack pens, manure deposited in a feed alley, exercise lot, etc.. Housing emissions from compost



bedded packs and open lot manure packs, where manure accumulates over weeks or months, are determined according to alternative methods due to the longer-term residence of manure in these pen types; see respective compost bedded pack barn and open lot documentation files for further info.

The methodology used to calculate housing emissions is adapted from the IFSM (Rotz, Corson, et al., 2023). Of note is that the equations described here were determined based on emissions in tiestall and freestall housing systems. In RuFaS, these equations may also be applied to determine emissions from manure deposited in other concrete areas and retained for a short time, such as open lot or bedded pack feed alleys. These systems were not represented in the original datasets used to generate these equations, and results should be interpreted with caution; however, the portion of manure deposited in feed alleys or other areas is relatively small, and emissions from this area are expected to be a small contributor to total GHG and nutrient losses.

Additionally, the following calculations are only utilized by the manual scraping, flush system, and alley scraper handler types. For the parlor cleaning handler type, manure in a parlor is assumed to be cleaned from floors/surfaces frequently and thus housing emissions should not be estimated.

Calculate housing CH₄ emissions

Manure deposited on barn floors or other housing areas is a small source of CH₄ emissions. The following method, from Chianese, Rotz, and Richard, 2009, is an empirically-derived equation consisting of a simple relationship between manure CH₄ emission rate, ambient temperature in the barn, and surface area covered by manure.

The soiled surface area (m²) value is calculated in the Animal module, using pen-level information (number of stalls, number of cows, etc.) and the soiled surface area value is passed to the manure module directly.

Table 9: The surface area per stall that is covered with manure is a function of the pen type and type of animal housed.

System Type	Lactating Cows	Closeup, Growing, or Calves
Tiestall	1.2 m ²	1.0 m ²
Freestall	3.5 m ²	2.5 m ²
Bedded Pack	5.0 m ²	5.0 m ²
Open Lot	3.0 m ²	3.0 m ²

The total surface area soiled with manure, based on the total number of animals, is as follows:

$$soiled_surface_area (m^2) = num_stalls * surface_area (m^2/animal)$$

[MN.HDL.4]

When:

- num_stalls: the number of stalls in the pen assigned to the handler
- surface_area (m²/animal): surface area per stall, provided in Table 8.

We use this surface area value to determine CH₄ emissions (kg) each day

$$housing\ CH_4\ (kg) = max^1(0.0, 0.13 * barn_temperature(C)) * \frac{soiled_surface_area\ (m^2)}{1000}$$



[MN.MET.1]

When:

- barn_temperature ($^{\circ}\text{C}$): ambient air temperature in the barn. Note that the max notation ensures that the temperature scaling parameter cannot be less than 0.13.
- soiled_surface_area (m^2): the total surface area soiled with manure

Calculate housing CO₂ emissions Housing CO₂ emissions are estimated similarly to CH₄ emissions, using an empirical equation based on soiled surface area and barn air temperature.

$$\text{housing } \text{CO}_2 \text{ (kg)} = \max^1(0.0, 0.0065 + \text{barn_temperature}(\text{C})) * \text{soiled_surface_area} \text{ (m}^2\text{)}$$

[MN.HDL.5]

When:

- barn_temperature ($^{\circ}\text{C}$): ambient air temperature in the barn. Note that the max notation ensures that the temperature scaling parameter cannot be less than 0.13.
- soiled_surface_area (m^2): the total surface area soiled with manure

Calculate volatile solids losses After housing CH₄ and CO₂ emissions are calculated, the total quantity of VS loss through microbial degradation can be calculated.

$$\text{total_VS_loss (kg)} = \text{housing } \text{CH}_4 \text{ (kg)} + \text{housing } \text{CO}_2 \text{ (kg)}$$

[MN.HDL.6]

When:

- housing CH₄ (kg): daily emissions of CH₄ from manure on barn floors, calculated in [MN.MET.1].
- housing CO₂ (kg): daily emissions of CO₂ from manure on barn floors, calculated in [MN.HDL.5].

The fraction of volatile solids lost from the degradable (dVS) and non-degradable VS (ndVS) fractions is assumed to be equal to the proportion of these two fractions in manure entering the processor.

$$\text{degradable_VS_frac} = \left(\frac{\text{degradable_VS}}{\text{total_VS}} \right)$$

[MN.ADG.7]

Calculate housing NH₃ emissions Ammonia N loss from manure is predicted using methods based on Rotz and Oenema, 2006. Here, estimated NH₃-N volatilized from the surface of manure is based on a function where the NH₃-N is transported to the free atmosphere through a pathway with a finite resistance. Daily NH₃-N loss depends primarily on pen type (which determines soiled surface area), manure TAN content, and barn air temperature. The same base equation for NH₃-N volatilization is utilized for estimation of both housing and storage NH₃-N emissions.

In the original work of Rotz and Oenema, 2006, housing NH₃-N emissions are based only on urine (not manure) TAN concentration, rather than total manure (urine + feces) TAN. Within RuFaS, urine nutrients are not tracked separately from feces/manure. Therefore, the model assumes, for simplicity, that all TAN originates from urine and thus animal-excreted urine TAN = manure TAN. However, to maintain consistency with documentation, what would ordinarily in RuFaS be referred to as manure TAN within RuFaS is referred to here as urine TAN, though urine mass here (kg/d) is reflective of actual estimated urine mass, not manure (urine + feces) mass.



- First, we need to derive the value of the equilibrium coefficient Q for the NH_3 gas in the air for a given concentration of TAN in stored slurry using Henry's law of distribution.

The concentration of NH_3 in the free atmosphere is assumed to be zero. Since Q is a function of the Henry's law coefficient K_h and a dissociation of ammonium coefficient K_a , we will calculate those first.

Henry's law coefficient (K_h)

$$K_h = 10^{\frac{1478}{\text{barn temperature} - 1.69}}$$

[MN.AMM.1]

When:

- Barn temperature (K): ambient air temperature in the barn

Dissociation coefficient of ammonium (K_a)

$$K_a = 1 + 10^{(0.09018 + (\frac{2729.9}{\text{barn temperature}} - pH))}$$

[MN.AMM.2]

When:

- Barn temperature (K): ambient air temperature in the barn
- pH: the pH of the manure solution, set to 7.5 by default

Equilibrium coefficient (Q)

$$Q = K_h * K_a$$

[MN.AMM.3]

When:

- K_h : Henry's law coefficient, calculated in [MN.AMM.1].
- K_a : Dissociation coefficient of ammonium, calculated in [MN.AMM.2].
- Second, we determine the effective total resistance value of NH_3 transport from manure solution to the surface and from the manure surface to the atmosphere.

$$\text{ammonia_resistance} = \text{HOUSING_SPECIFIC_CONSTANT} * (1 - 0.027 * (20.0 - \text{barn temperature}))$$

[MN.AMM.4]

When:



- HOUSING_SPECIFIC_CONSTANT: a housing-specific constant value, set to 260 s/m.
- Barn temperature ($^{\circ}C$): ambient air temperature in the barn.
- Next, the rate of NH_3 -N loss in kg N/m² from manure on the barn floor is calculated

$$NH_3N \text{ emission rate (kg N/m}^2\text{)} = \frac{(TAN * c * y)}{(r * M * Q)}$$

[MN.AMM.5]**When:**

- TAN (kg N/m²): Mass of ammoniacal N in barn floor manure
- c: time conversion constant (86400 s per d)
- y: manure density, set to 990 kg/m³
- r: the resistance of NH_3 transfer from solution to manure surface, and from manure surface to atmosphere, determined in **[MN.AMM.4]**
- M: urine mass (received from animal module)
- Q: equilibrium coefficient, calculated in **[MN.AMM.3]**
- Lastly, we calculate total NH_3 -N emissions (kg), based on the emission rate we just calculated and the soiled surface area.

$$NH_3N \text{ emissions (kg)} = NH_3N_rate * soiled_surface_area$$

[MN.AMM.7]**When:**

- NH3N_rate (kg N/m²): Rate of NH_3 -N loss (kg/m²) from manure, calculated in **[MN.AMM.5]**
- soiled_surface_area (m²): the total surface area soiled with manure

Manure composition update Below is a summary of updates to ManureStream variables.

The formulas below may be a summarization of multiple steps detailed above, and are intended to provide an overview of what mass losses/gains are reflected in the value of each variable.

Equations in the table below are in the format of “Output/exiting value” = “Entering processor value” +/- XYZ. “Entering” refers to the manure entering the processor (i.e., being loaded into the digester) and output variables reflect the manure leaving the processor (i.e., digestate leaving the digester). The Calculation column describes how the variable is updated in the processor.



C. Output Variables

Table 10: Calculated manure storage variables and their units

Variable	Units	Calculation
water	kg	Entering water (kg) + (total_cleaning_water (m ³) × WATER_DENSITY_KG_PER_M3)
total_ammoniacal_nitrogen	kg	min(0, entering ammoniacal_nitrogen (kg) – NH ₃ -N emissions (kg))
nitrogen	kg	min(0, entering nitrogen (kg) – NH ₃ -N emissions (kg))
phosphorus	kg	Entering phosphorus (kg)
potassium	kg	Entering potassium (kg)
ash	kg	Entering ash (kg)
non_degradable_volatile_solids		Entering non_degradable_volatile_solids – (total_VS_loss × (1 – degradable_VS_frac))
degradable_volatile_solids		Entering degradable_volatile_solids – (total_VS_loss × degradable_VS_frac)
total_solids	kg	Entering total_solids – total_VS_loss
volume	m ³	$\frac{\text{Entering volume} - \text{total_VS_loss}}{\text{ManureConstants.SLURRY_MANURE_DENSITY}}$ ^{1,2}

¹ WATER_DENSITY_KG_PER_M3: a constant with a value of 0.997 kg/m³.

² Note that for parlor cleaning handlers, the value of all housing emissions variables will be reported as 0.

V. Solid Liquid Separators

A. Introduction

A solid-liquid separator (SLS) is a specialized piece of equipment or system designed to separate larger, solid particles from the liquid component of manure. This type of system may be implemented for a variety of reasons, such as to improve ease of handling of manure liquid, improve the nutrient concentration in manure liquid, reduce storage volume required for manure lagoons or other storage systems, prevent solid accumulation in a covered manure storage, or reclaim manure solids for use as bedding or compost.

The solid fraction of manure slurry is composed of fibers originating primarily from manure, but also from feed, bedding, and other environmental sources. Once mechanically separated, the moisture content of the solid fraction ranges from 70% to 90%, depending on the specific separator system used. To further reduce moisture content of the separated solids, an additional dewatering or drying step may be incorporated. Manure solids may be directly used or sold for animal bedding (after stabilization), composted, or land applied. After the manure solids are mechanically separated, the remaining liquid fraction is composed of small particles, water, and most of the nutrients present in the manure. Because the bulk of relevant nutrients (e.g., P, N, K) are mainly associated with the small particles which remain with the liquid fraction after separation occurs, separating the larger, less nutrient-dense particles out from the slurry liquid enriches the concentration of these nutrients in the liquid fraction. Solid-liquid separation also makes the manure slurry easier to pump, transport, and apply to fields, as large particles that may clog lines and sprayers are removed.

Implementation in RuFaS

In RuFaS, solid liquid separators currently represent mechanical, short retention time pieces of equipment. GHG emissions and other nutrient transformations from long-retention separators such as weeping walls or settling basins are not yet represented in the model. Because of this, the impact of these longer retention separators can only be approximated via modification of the separation efficiencies of the short retention time methods.



Currently, SLS inputs are simply nutrient-specific separation efficiencies that reflect the proportion of a specific nutrient that is separated into the solids fraction. With this, essentially any type of mechanical manure separation system can be modeled, as long as effective separation efficiencies are known. Manure is assumed to be loaded, processed, and passed to the next processor within a single day. Default separation efficiencies exist for two common types of SLS - a screw press and a rotary screen. The separated manure solids and remaining liquid fraction are quantified and can be managed in separate, downstream manure management systems in RuFaS. However, separated solids cannot be directly recycled (i.e., utilized with the specific nutrient composition of those separated solids) “upstream” as bedding.

Required User Inputs

Table 11: The required inputs of this section.

Variable	Definition (units)	Description
Name	none	Unique identifier of the specific separator configuration used.
type	rotary screen or screw press	The type of solid liquid separator ; selection of this input indicates which default separations efficiencies should be used, however, any and all separation efficiencies may also be overwritten by user input.
separated_solids_dry_matter	none	percent dry matter by mass of the manure solids post solid-liquid separation.
total_solids_efficiency	none	the proportion of manure total solids (TS) that are separated into the manure solids fraction by the separator.
volatile_solids_efficiency	none	the proportion of manure volatile solids (VS) that are separated into the manure solids fraction by the separator.
nitrogen_efficiency	none	the proportion of manure total nitrogen that is separated into the manure solids fraction by the separator.
ammoniacal_nitrogen_efficiency	none	the proportion of manure ammoniacal nitrogen that is separated into the manure solids fraction by the separator.
phosphorus_efficiency	none	the proportion of manure phosphorus that is separated into the manure solids fraction by the separator.
potassium_efficiency	none	the proportion of manure potassium that is separated into the manure solids fraction by the separator.
ash_efficiency	none	the proportion of manure ash that is separated into the manure solids fraction by the separator.

Other inputs

Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

- water
- ammoniacal_nitrogen
- nitrogen



- phosphorus
- potassium
- ash
- non_degradable_volatile_solids
- degradable_volatile_solids
- total_solids
- volume

Classes

Table 12: List of Python classes for solid liquid separators.

Handlers	Description
Separator (Processor)	separator.py

Expected Outputs

- Two sets of ManureStream variables, representing the separated solids (“SeparatedSolids”) and liquid fraction (“SeparatedLiquid”), respectively

B. Methodology

Separate nutrients

The equations below describe the general process for separating nutrients between liquid and solid fractions. The general equation is as follows:

$$\text{Separated solids nutrient content} = \text{received manure nutrient} * \text{separation efficiency}$$

[MN.SEP.1]

$$\text{Separated liquid nutrient content} = \text{received manure nutrient} * (1 - \text{separation efficiency})$$

[MN.SEP.2]

When:

- Received manure nutrient (kg): quantity of the specific nutrient in manure being loaded into the separator on a single day.

Received manure nutrient (kg): quantity of the specific nutrient in manure being loaded into the separator on a single day.

Nutrients that are separated according to this pattern are presented in the table below. The default separation efficiencies, as well as minimum and maximum allowable separation efficiencies, for the rotary screen and screw press separators are also provided (Hegg, R. E. Larson, and Moore, 1981; Mukhtar, Sweeten, and Auvermann, 1999; Varma et al., 2021).



Table 13: The default, minimums, and maximums for various separation efficiencies.

Type	Variable	Default	Min	Max
Rotary Screen	Total solids	0.35	0.25	0.4
	Nitrogen	0.3	0.25	0.35
	Ammoniacal N	0.15	0.1	0.2
	Phosphorus	0.4	0.3	0.45
	Potassium	0.15	0.05	0.2
	Ash	0.2	0.05	0.3
	Volatile solids	0.35	0.3	0.45
Screw Press	Total solids	0.25	0.15	0.35
	Nitrogen	0.3	0.2	0.35
	Ammoniacal N	0.15	0.05	0.2
	Phosphorus	0.2	0.1	0.35
	Potassium	0.23	0.15	0.35
	Ash	0.2	0.05	0.3
	Volatile solids	0.25	0.2	0.4

¹ (Jørgensen and Jensen, 2009; Fournel et al., 2019)

Calculate volatile solids fractions

Separated solids fraction After the total quantity of volatile solids (VS) removed to the solids fraction is calculated, we then adjust the quantity of degradable (dVS) and non-degradable VS (ndVS) in each fraction according to their proportion in incoming manure.

$$degradable_VS_frac = \frac{degradable_VS}{total_VS}$$

[MN.ADG.7]

When:

- `degradable_VS` (kg): mass of degradable VS in manure loaded into the separator
- `total_VS` (kg): mass of total VS in manure loaded into the separator

Using the degradable VS fraction value, we can then determine the quantity of degradable and non-degradable VS in separated solids.

`solidsdVS` (kg) = (`totalVS` (kg) * separation efficiency) * `degradableVSfrac`

`solidsndVS` (kg) = (`totalVS` (kg) * separation efficiency) * (1 - `degradableVSfrac`)

- `total_VS` (kg): mass of total VS in manure loaded into the separator
- separation efficiency: the separation efficiency for total VS, i.e., proportion of manure VS loaded into the separator that are partitioned into the solid fraction
- `degradable_VS_frac`: the proportion of total VS that are degradable VS



Separated liquid fraction The quantities of dVS and ndVS in the separated liquid fraction are simply the total quantity loaded into the separator, minus the quantity partitioned into the solid fraction.

liquid_dVS (kg) = total_dVS (kg) - solids_dVS (kg)

liquid_ndVS (kg) = total_ndVS (kg) - solids_ndVS (kg)

- total_VS (kg): mass of total VS in manure loaded into the separator
- total_ndVS (kg): mass of total ndVS in manure loaded into the separator
- solids_dVS (kg): mass of dVS separated from raw manure into the solids fraction
- solids_ndVS (kg): mass of ndVS separated from raw manure into the solids fraction

Calculate total mass and water

Separated solids fraction Total mass of the separated solids fraction is determined by dividing the mass of separated solids by the user-inputted separated solids dry matter content.

$$\text{Separated solids mass (kg)} = \frac{\text{Separated solids TS (kg)}}{\text{Separated solids \%DM}}$$

[MN.SEP.3]

When:

- Separated solids TS (kg): the mass of solids in the separated manure solids fraction
- Separated solids %DM: user-inputted separated solids dry matter content

The mass of water in the separated solids fraction can then be determined as follows, given the assumption that total mass is equal to the sum of solids plus water:

$$\text{Separated solids water (kg)} = \text{Separated solids mass (kg)} - \text{Separated solids TS (kg)}$$

Separated liquid fraction The total mass of the separated liquid fraction, as well as the mass of water, are simply equal to the mass and water in manure loaded into the separator, minus the quantity of each respective value partitioned into the separated solids fraction.

Separated solids mass (kg) = Received mass (kg) - Separated solids mass (kg)
Separated solids water (kg) = Received water (kg) - Separated solids water (kg)

Calculate volume

Volume of each separated fraction is determined by dividing the mass of each fraction by its respective density:

$$\text{Separated solids volume } m^3 = \frac{\text{Separated solids mass}}{\text{SOLID_MANURE_DENSITY}}$$

[MN.SEP.4]

$$\text{Separated liquid volume } m^3 = \frac{\text{Separated liquid mass}}{\text{LIQUID_MANURE_DENSITY}}$$



[MN.SEP.5]

When:

- SOLID_MANURE_DENSITY (kg/ m³): The default density of solid manure, set to 700 kg/ m³
- LIQUID_MANURE_DENSITY(kg/ m³): The default density of liquid manure, set to 900 kg/ m³

Manure composition update

Below is a summary of updates to ManureStream variables. Note that the formulas below may be a summarization of multiple steps detailed above, and are intended to provide an overview of what mass losses/gains are reflected in the value of each variable.

Equations in the table below are in the format of “Output/exiting value” = “Entering processor value” +/- XYZ. “Entering” refers to the manure entering the processor (i.e., being loaded into the digester) and output variables reflect the manure leaving the processor (i.e., digestate leaving the digester). The Calculation column describes how the variable is updated in the processor.

C. Output Variables

Table 14: Solids and liquid fraction calculations for separated manure components

Variable	Units	Calculation (Solids Fraction)	Calculation (Liquid Fraction)
water	kg	Separated solids mass (kg) – Separated solids TS (kg)	Entering water (kg) – Separated solids water (kg)
total_ammoniacal _nitrogen	kg	Entering ammoniacal nitrogen (kg) × TAN removal efficiency	Entering ammoniacal nitrogen (kg) × (1 – TAN removal efficiency)
nitrogen	kg	Entering nitrogen (kg) × N removal efficiency	Entering nitrogen (kg) × (1 – N removal efficiency)
phosphorus	kg	Entering phosphorus (kg) × phosphorus removal efficiency	Entering phosphorus (kg) × (1 – phosphorus removal efficiency)
potassium	kg	Entering potassium (kg) × potassium removal efficiency	Entering potassium (kg) × (1 – potassium removal efficiency)
ash	kg	Entering ash (kg) × potassium removal efficiency	Entering ash (kg) × (1 – potassium removal efficiency)
non_degradable _volatile_solids	-	Entering ndVS (kg) × VS removal efficiency × (1 – degradable_VS_frac)	Entering ndVS (kg) × (1 – VS removal efficiency) × (1 – degradable_VS_frac)
degradable _volatile_solids	-	Entering dVS (kg) × VS removal efficiency × degradable_VS_frac	Entering dVS (kg) × (1 – VS removal efficiency) × degradable_VS_frac
total_solids	kg	Entering TS (kg) × TS removal efficiency	Entering TS (kg) × (1 – TS removal efficiency)
volume	m ³	$\frac{\text{Separated solids mass (kg)}}{\text{SOLID_MANURE_DENSITY}}$	$\frac{\text{Separated liquid mass (kg)}}{\text{LIQUID_MANURE_DENSITY}}$

VI. Anaerobic Digestion**A. Introduction**

Anaerobic digestion is a process where dairy cow manure is treated in an oxygen-free (anaerobic) environment to produce biogas, containing approximately 60% CH₄, 40% CO₂, which can be utilized as an on-farm or



exported energy source. Additional benefits of anaerobic digestion include reduced manure odor, improved stability and quality of manure for fertilization purposes, and reductions in nutrient losses via undesirable greenhouse gas emissions.

Manure can undergo anaerobic digestion in a specialized anaerobic digestion chamber/system, usually referred to simply as a 'digester', or can occur in other manure storage systems that create anaerobic conditions, such as anaerobic lagoons.

Implementation of RuFaS

The anaerobic digestion submodule in RuFaS currently represents anaerobic digestion within an enclosed, mechanical digester system. The following assumptions are made in the RuFaS anaerobic digestion submodule:

- The digester represented is assumed to be a mesophilic, continuous stirred-tank reactor (CSTR).
- Manure is loaded into the digester and removed from the digester once daily.
- The digester is fully functional at the start of the simulation, i.e., the digester is full of substrate and the microbial population has stabilized.
- Residence time of manure in the digester is not modeled. As a result, the composition of effluent exiting the digester each day is identical to the influent composition, with the exception of nutrient losses or transformations that occur in the digester.
- At this time, CH₄ generation and volatile solids destruction is based strictly on the quantity of manure volatile solids loaded; other factors are not considered at this time.

The anaerobic submodule has two primary functions in RuFaS:

- Estimate daily methane production (kg/d) based on the daily mass of manure volatile solids (VS) loaded into the digester.
 - VS loading is dependent on the number and type of animals contributing manure to the digester, the diet of the animals, quantity and type of bedding, and any upstream manure handling processes, e.g., solid liquid separation, water addition, etc.
- Update the composition of the liquid manure effluent leaving the digester, which enters the anaerobic lagoon.
 - Reflecting VS loss in effluent exiting the digester is essential to capture the reduction in methane emissions from digestate compared to undigested, liquid manure, as well as changes in proportion of inorganic (ammoniacal) to total nitrogen.



Required User Inputs

Table 15: Required inputs for this section.

Variable	Units	Description
Name	none	Unique identifier of the specific anaerobic digester configuration used.
Hydraulic_retention_time	days	Number of days manure spends in the anaerobic digester. Note that this variable is not utilized directly by the module, but is utilized by the Economics, Emissions and Energy module.
Anaerobic_digestion_temperature_set_point	°C	Temperature set point for the anaerobic digestion. This input is utilized in the conversion of CH ₄ and CO ₂ generation volume to mass; it does not directly influence CH ₄ emissions.
biogas_leakage_fraction	none	Fraction of biogas generated in the anaerobic digester that escapes to the atmosphere through unintended leakage and is not collected by the gas capture system .

Other inputs

Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

- water
- ammoniacal_nitrogen
- nitrogen
- phosphorus
- potassium
- ash
- non_degradable_volatile_solids
- degradable_volatile_solids
- total_solids
- volume



Classes

Table 16: List of Python classes for anaerobic digestors.

Handlers	Description
AnaerobicDigester	anaerobic_digester.py it inherits behavior from the base class, Digester; however, at this time, there is no functionality included in the base Digester class. Therefore all methods are contained within the anaerobic_digestion.py child class

Expected Outputs

- `captured_biogas_volume` (m³): Captured biogas (assumed to be composed of 40% CO₂, 60% CH₄) volume after accounting for leakage on the current day
- `captured_methane_volume` (m³): Captured methane volume on the current day, after accounting for leakage
- `methane_leakage_mass` (kg): Mass of CH₄ lost to the atmosphere through unintended leakage on the current day. This variable is expressed as mass as opposed to volume as CH₄ emissions are reported in kg in the rest of the manure module and other RuFaS modules

B. Methodology

Calculate Daily Methane Generation

Description: calculates volume of methane (CH₄) generated from a CSTR digester. Methane generation is estimated from the daily loading of manure volatile solids (VS). Degradable (VSd) and non-degradable (VSnd) VS are tracked separately but the ratio of VSd : VSnd does not affect CH₄ estimation; only the total quantity of VS is considered. To perform this calculation, we make several assumptions/simplifications:

- The ratio of chemical oxygen demand (COD): VS in dairy manure is assumed to be 1.2 to 1. 1 kg of COD can generate 0.4 kg of methane. Therefore, 1 kg VS reduction/degradation in the anaerobic digester = 1.2 kg COD = 480 L CH₄. In other words, each kg VS of reduced is assumed to generate 480 L of CH₄.
- A CSTR reduces manure VS content by approximately 50%. This is a generalization across CSTR digesters of varying efficiencies, based on expert opinion from W. Liao (MSU) and A. Leytem (USDA-ARS).
- Considering that 480 L of CH₄ are generated per kg of VS destroyed, and approximately 50% of VS loaded are anticipated to be destroyed, we estimate CH₄ generation by assuming 240 L CH₄ are generated per VS kg loaded into the digester; this is also in alignment with the IPCC (2019) Tier II manure CH₄ Bo value.
- Lastly, the volumetric ratio of CH₄ to CO₂ generation in the CSTR is assumed to be 6:4 (e.g. generation of 60% CH₄, 40% CO₂ biogas) based on commonly cited digester performance metrics (e.g., EPA, Fernández et al., 2015). The total quantity of VS destroyed in anaerobic digestion is then assumed to be equal to the quantity of CH₄ and CO₂ generated in the digester. This assumption is made due to a lack of data on destruction of degradable vs. non-degradable VS in anaerobic digestion.

$$\text{generated_methane_volume (m}^3\text{)} = \text{ACHIEVABLE_METHANE_EMISSION} * \text{total_volatile_solids (kg)}$$

**[MN.ADG.1]****When:**

- `ACHIEVABLE_METHANE_EMISSION` = achievable methane generation constant ($\text{m}^3 \text{CH}_4$ per kg VS loaded into digester); Constant Value: $0.24 \text{ m}^3 \text{CH}_4/\text{kg VS}$
- `total_volatile_solids` = daily mass (kg) of manure total volatile solids loaded into the digester, received from `ManureStream(s)`

Lastly, we need to convert daily CH_4 volume (`generated_methane_volume`) to CH_4 mass. First we calculate CH_4 density according to the user-provided digestion setpoint temperature, then we apply the density value to the volume of CH_4 generated.

$$\text{methane_density} = \frac{\text{METHANE_MOLAR_MASS}}{(\text{IDEAL_GAS_LAW_R} * (\text{temperature_set_point} + \text{CELSIUS_TO_KELVIN}))}$$

[MN.ADG.2]**When:**

- `METHANE_MOLAR_MASS` (16.04 g/mol): molar mass of CH_4
- `IDEAL_GAS_LAW_R` (0.0821 L atm/mol K): ideal gas law R value
- `temperature_set_point` ($^{\circ}\text{C}$): user-provided digestion set point temperature
- `CELSIUS_TO_KELVIN` (273.15): value to convert $^{\circ}\text{C}$ temperature values to K

$$\text{generated_methane_mass (kg)} = \text{generated_methane_volume (m}^3\text{)} * \text{methane_density}$$

[MN.ADG.3]**When:**

- `generated_methane_volume` (m^3): volume of CH_4 generated in the digester on a single day, calculated in **[MN.ADG.1]**.

Calculate destroyed volatile solids

`_destroy_volatile_solids`

Description: Microbes convert (destroy) VS during anaerobic digestion and produce biogas containing primarily CH_4 and CO_2 . Therefore, the quantity of VS is assumed to be equal to the mass of CH_4 and CO_2 generated. In this section, we calculate the total mass of CO_2 and CH_4 generated, which is used later to update the degradable and non-degradable VS values of the `ManureStream` instance passed to the next processor.

- First, we calculate the density of CO_2 based on the user-provided digestion setpoint temperature.

$$\text{carbon_dioxide_density} = \frac{\text{CARBON_DIOXIDE_MOLAR_MASS}}{(\text{IDEAL_GAS_LAW_R} * (\text{temperature_set_point} + \text{CELSIUS_TO_KELVIN}))}$$

[MN.ADG.4]**When:**



- CARBON_DIOXIDE_MOLAR_MASS (44.01 g/mol): molar mass of CO₂
 - IDEAL_GAS_LAW_R (0.0821 L atm/mol K): ideal gas law R value
 - temperature_set_point (°C): user-provided digestion set point temperature
 - CELSIUS_TO_KELVIN (273.15): value to convert °C temperature values to K
- Second, we determine the quantity of CO₂ volume and mass generated, assuming digester biogas contains a 60:40 volumetric ratio of CH₄ to CO₂.

$$\text{generated_carbon_dioxide_mass} = (\text{generated_methane_volume} * \text{CARBON_DIOXIDE_TO_METHANE_RATIO} * \text{CARBON_DIOXIDE_DENSITY})$$

[MN.ADG.5]

When:

- CARBON_DIOXIDE_MOLAR_MASS (44.01 g/mol): molar mass of CO₂; Constant Value: = 4/6 L/L (0.667)
 - carbon_dioxide_density (kg per m³) = ideal gas law value to convert CO₂ from mass to volume
- Third, we calculate the total destruction of total VS.

$$\text{total_volatile_solids_destruction} = \text{generated_methane_mass} + \text{generated_carbon_dioxide_mass}$$

[MN.ADG.6]

- We then utilize the value of total_volatile_solids_destruction (kg) to update VSd and VSnd using _destroy_volatile_solids. As mentioned above, the total quantity of VS destroyed is partitioned between VSd and VSnd according to the proportion of the two fractions in manure entering the digester. E.g., if manure entering contained 80% VSd and 20% VSnd, 80% of destroyed VS will be subtracted from VSd, and 20% from VSnd. To do this, we calculate the ratio of VSd to VS (degradable_volatile_solids_frac), apply this fraction to the total_volatile_solids_destruction value to determine the updated VSd value, then determine the updated VSnd value.

$$\text{degradable_VS_frac} = \frac{\text{degradable_VS (kg)}}{\text{total_VS (kg)}}$$

[MN.ADG.7]

$$\text{degradable_VS} = \text{degradable_VS (kg)} - (\text{total_VS_destruction (kg)} * \text{degradable_VS_frac})$$

[MN.ADG.8]



$$non_degradable_VS = non_degradable_VS (kg) - total_VS_destruction * (1.0 - degradable_VS_frac (kg))$$

[MN.ADG.9]

Calculate methane leakage`_calculate_methane_leakage`

Description: Calculates the volume of CH₄ generated that is lost to the atmosphere via leakage. The leakage fraction is currently a user input with a default value of 1%, which represents a conservative leakage rate. Leakage is largely dependent on the age and type of digester and should ideally be provided by the user for specificity.

$$methane_leakage_volume (m^3) = generated_methane_volume (m^3) * biogas_leakage_fraction$$

[MN.ADG.10]

When:

- `generated_methane_volume (m3)`: volume of CH₄ generated in the digester on a single day, calculated in [MN.ADG.1]
- `biogas_leakage_fraction (%)`: fraction of biogas generated in the anaerobic digester that escapes to the atmosphere through unintended leakage; Default Value: 0.01 (1%)

Update digester effluent composition`_report_anaerobic_digester_outputs`

The calculations below are some additional prerequisites to generating anaerobic digestion-specific outputs.

- The equation below is used to calculate the quantity of net, captured gas according to the quantity of biogas leakage.

$$captured_methane_volume (m^3) = generated_methane_volume (m^3) - methane_leakage_volume (m^3)$$

[MN.ADG.11]

When:

- `generated_methane_volume (m3)`: total volume of CH₄ generated in the digester on a specific day
- `methane_leakage_volume (m3)`: the volume of CH₄ generated that is lost to the atmosphere via leakage
- The equation below is used to calculate the updated volume of manure in the digester, accounting for the volume of destroyed VS.

$$updated_volume(m^3) = incoming_volume(m^3) - \left(\frac{total_volatile_solids_destruction(kg)}{ManureConstants.SLURRY_MANURE_DENSITY} \right)$$



[MN.ADG.12]

When:

- $\text{updated_volume (m}^3\text{)} = \text{incoming_volume (m}^3\text{)} - (\text{total_volatile_solids_destruction (kg)} / \text{Manure-Constants.SLURRY_MANURE_DENSITY})$
- Microbial processes during anaerobic digestion are known to increase the proportion/mass of total ammoniacal N (TAN), though the total mass of N is generally not different pre and post-digestion (Aguirre-Villegas, R. A. Larson, and Sharara, 2019). To reflect this, the proportion of TAN in manure in the digester is multiplied by a fixed factor. The factor (TAN_INCREASE_FACTOR, 1.60) was chosen based on a target of 50% loss of total N via NH₃-N emissions from a subsequent digestate lagoon, as reported by the USDA GHG estimation guidelines for uncovered digestate storage (Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024).

$$\text{updated_ammoniacal_nitrogen(kg)} = \min(\text{ammoniacal_nitrogen(kg)} * \text{TAN_INCREASE_FACTOR}, \text{nitrogen(kg)})$$

[MN.ADG.13]

When:

- ammoniacal_nitrogen (kg): the mass of ammoniacal N in manure loaded into the digester on a single day
- TAN_INCREASE_FACTOR: factor by which total ammoniacal nitrogen content is increased by the anaerobic digestion process, set to 1.60
- Note that the “min” notation prevents manure TAN from exceeding manure total N.

Manure composition update Below is a summary of updates to ManureStream variables. Note that the formulas below may be a summarization of multiple steps detailed above, and are intended to provide an overview of what mass losses/gains are reflected in the value of each variable. Equations in the table below are in the format of “Output/exiting value” = “Entering processor value” +/- XYZ. “Entering” refers to the manure entering the processor (i.e., being loaded into the digester) and output variables reflect the manure leaving the processor (i.e., digestate leaving the digester). The Calculation column describes how the variable is updated in the processor.

C. Output Variables

Table 17: Calculated anaerobic digestion outputs.

Variable	Units	Calculation
water	kg	Entering water (kg)
total_ammoniacal_nitrogen	kg	Entering ammoniacal_nitrogen (kg) TAN_INCREASE_FACTOR, nitrogen (kg)
nitrogen	kg	Entering nitrogen (kg)
phosphorus	kg	Entering phosphorus (kg)
potassium	kg	Entering potassium (kg)

Continued on next page



Variable	Units	Calculation
ash	kg	Entering ash (kg)
non_degradable_volatile_solids		Entering non_degradable_volatile_solids (kg) – total_volatile_solids_destruction (kg) × (1.0 – degradable_volatile_solids_frac)
degradable_volatile_solids		Entering degradable_volatile_solids (kg) – total_volatile_solids_destruction (kg) × degradable_volatile_solids_frac
total_solids	kg	Entering total_solids (kg) – total_volatile_solids_destruction (kg)
volume	m ³	Entering volume (m ³) – $\frac{\text{total_volatile_solids_destruction (kg)}}{\text{ManureConstants.SLURRY_MANURE_DENSITY}}$



VII. Slurry Storage

A. Introduction

Manure that is stored and managed at 7 to 12% dry matter is generally considered to be “slurry” manure. Several common options exist for storing manure at this %DM range. Slurry may be stored in underfloor pits, where manure is deposited directly into the pit through slatted floors, or is moved to an underfloor storage via scrapers or other manure handling systems. Manure may also be transported to outdoor storage tanks or pits/basins, which may be covered or uncovered.

Compared to anaerobic lagoons, slurry storages are typically of a smaller capacity, and do not result in controlled treatment (e.g., reduction of odor, N content reduction, organic matter decomposition) of manure. Slurry storages are typically emptied more frequently than liquid manure storages like anaerobic lagoons and contain more concentrated manure. In general, the biological processes in slurry storages and anaerobic lagoons are similar: microbes break down manure carbohydrates and proteins, resulting in CO₂, CH₄, and N₂O emissions, and mineralization of organic to inorganic N, and N losses occur through NH₃ volatilization at the manure surface. However, management of these two types of liquid manure storages differs as described above, which results in differences in emissions and nutrient losses.

Implementation in RuFaS There are two options for slurry storage in RuFaS, slurry storage outdoor and slurry storage underfloor, which function almost identically. The key differences between the two methods are presented in Table 13. Because the two methods are highly similar, both are covered in this document.

Table 18: Key differences for two options of slurry storage.

	Slurry Storage Underfloor	Slurry Storage Outdoor
Temperature	Barn temperature method	Ambient temperature method
Cover options	Only “no cover” permitted	Cover, cover and flare, crust, or no cover
Precipitation volume	Precipitation excluded from storage	Precipitation excluded or included depending on cover option selection

In the slurry storage submodules, accumulated manure in storage is modeled on a daily timestep. Nutrient/mass gains from daily addition of manure (feces/urine, bedding, wash water) to storage, and precipitation volume entering storage, are tracked. Gas emissions are calculated daily based on the quantity of nutrients in stored manure, manure temperature, storage type, use of a cover, and storage duration. Manure composition is then updated according to net nutrient losses/gains. Manure accumulates in storage until the end of the user-defined storage interval is reached. However, quantities of manure may additionally be removed from storage according to the user-defined manure application schedule.



Required User Inputs

Table 19: Required inputs for the slurry storage section.

Variable	Units	Description
Name	none	Unique identifier of the specific slurry storage configuration used.
Capacity	m ³	The volumetric capacity of the slurry storage, in m ³ . Note that this variable is a placeholder at this time, and does not influence model calculations.
Cover	slurry or underfloor	the default value is “no cover”, as these storages do not generally have a synthetic cover, and typically receive too much surface disturbance to form a crust. Note that precipitation is always excluded from slurry storage underfloor given they are assumed to be completely covered or indoors; Default value for slurry storage outdoor is “no cover”. Cover (represents either a synthetic, precipitation-excluding cover, or an enclosed tank) or crust (a naturally-forming crust over > 50% of the stored manure surface) are also options.
Surface_area	m ²	The surface area of the slurry storage.
Storage_time_period	days	The number of days that manure is stored between emptying events. At the end of this interval, the manure storage is emptied completely.

Other inputs

Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

- water
- ammoniacal_nitrogen
- nitrogen
- phosphorus
- potassium
- ash
- non_degradable_volatile_solids
- degradable_volatile_solids
- total_solids
- volume



Python classes for slurry storage

Slurry Storage	Description
SlurryStorageOutdoor(Storage)	aslurry_storage_outdoor.py
SlurryStorageUnderfloor(Storage)	slurry_storage_outdoor.py; The content below is representative of both types of slurry storage, with specific differences between the two noted explicitly.

Expected Outputs

- Two sets of ManureStream variables, representing the separated solids ("SeparatedSolids") and liquid fraction ("SeparatedLiquid"), respectively

B. Methodology

Calculate manure temperature Slurry storage outdoor: `_determine_outdoor_storage_temperature`
 Slurry storage underfloor: `_determine_barn_temperature`

Temperature of stored manure is assumed to be equal throughout the entire mass of manure. In slurry storage underfloor, manure temperature is assumed to be equal to air temperature, but is bounded to 5 to 30°C. In slurry storage outdoor, manure temperature is assumed to be equal to air temperature, but is bounded to 0 to 35°C.

Calculate storage surface area Exposed surface area (m²) of the manure in storage is important in determining NH₃-N emissions, as well as in determining precipitation volume added to storage if the storage is not covered or indoors. Wherever possible, this value should be provided by the user if modeling a real farm. If farm-specific information is unavailable or the farm being modeled is theoretical, the surface area should be estimated using tools like the USDA's Animal Waste Management Version 2.4.1. However, the RuFaS team recognizes that minimizing required inputs is desirable, though a fixed storage surface area is undesirable due to the variability in storage structure size and surface area. With this, an equation was developed that estimates storage surface area based on the following assumptions:

- All manure excreted by animals on the farm enters the specified storage. At this time, the Manure module is not capable of assessing the proportion of manure excreted that is stored in the defined storages, therefore, all manure is assumed to be stored in the current storage, for the purposes of surface area estimation.
- The storage is 15 ft deep, with vertical walls.
- The storage receives 2500 mm of precipitation per year.
- Herd composition, and thus manure excretion, is fixed, and the number of animals in each life stage class is proportional to the number of mature cows.

A constant value was derived to calculate estimated manure excretion based on the number of mature cows housed on the farm (a user input). The average number of animals in each class was determined according to default RuFaS animal lifecycle inputs, and the total mass and volume of manure excreted by the herd was calculated. This resulted in an estimated daily herd-wide manure excretion of 168.6 kg or 0.118 m³ of manure per mature cow housed on the farm. The resulting equation is used to calculate storage surface area (m²).

$$surface_area(m^2) = \frac{(cow_num * MANURE_CONVERSION_CONSTANT * storage_time * FREEBOARD_CONSTANT)}{(DEPTH_CONSTANT - PRECIPITATION_CONSTANT)}$$



[MN.STO.1]

When:

- `cow_num`: user-inputted number of mature cows housed on the farm
- `MANURE_CONVERSION_CONSTANT`: Factor to estimate m^3 of herd-wide manure produced per day per mature cow housed on the farm, set to 0.1175 m^3 .
- `storage_time` (days): user-inputted number of days that manure is stored in this storage for before being emptied.
- `FREEBOARD_CONSTANT`: the volume allowance above the maximum volume of a slurry or liquid manure storage, set to 1.20 (20%).
- `DEPTH_CONSTANT`: value for slurry or liquid manure storage depth, set to 4.572 m (15 feet).
- `PRECIPITATION_CONSTANT`: The annual precipitation constant value, used only in determination of storage surface area if surface area is not provided by the user, set to 0.25 m.

Calculate precipitation volume

Covers have implications for inclusion or exclusion of precipitation volume, as well as for N_2O emissions. Four cover options exist for slurry storages:

- “Cover”: An impermeable cover that does not permit precipitation to enter the storage.
- “Cover and flare”: An impermeable cover with flaring of methane produced in storage. See Cover and Flare section.
- “Crust”: A naturally forming crust exists on the surface of the slurry storage.
- “No cover”: Storage is not covered or indoors.

The cover type for slurry storage underfloor in the default manure management file is “uncovered”, as these storages are typically not enclosed. However, precipitation is always excluded from underfloor slurry storages, regardless of the cover type – see Precipitation below.

Precipitation volume for uncovered outdoor slurry storages is calculated as follows:

$$\text{Daily precipitation volume}(\text{m}^3) = \text{storage surface area}(\text{m}^2) * \text{precipitation}(\text{m})$$

[MN.STO.2]

When:

- Storage surface area: the user-defined or model-estimated storage surface area (m^2).
- Precipitation: the daily amount of precipitation (m).

Calculate methane emissions

`_calculate_methane_emissions`

We use an adaptation of a method originally conceived by Sommer, Petersen, and Moller, 2004 to calculate daily emissions of CH_4 from degradable and non-degradable VS in slurry. These equations focus on the degradation of degradable and non-degradable volatile solids (VS) present in the manure. Factors



like degradable and non-degradable VS (VS_d and VS_{nd}) content in storage, temperature, and location (indoor/outdoor) affect estimated CH₄ emissions. We apply the original method from Sommer, Petersen, and Moller, 2004 with updated dairy manure Arrhenius and activation energy values from Elsgaard, Olsen, and Petersen, 2016 and Petersen et al., 2024.

Methane emissions are calculated in the same way for slurry storage outdoor and underfloor, with the exception that temperature of manure in outdoor vs. underfloor slurry storage is determined differently, as described below. The same equation is utilized to calculate CH₄ emissions from VS_d and VS_{nd}, though the rate-correcting factor differs between the two.

First, we must calculate the value of the Arrhenius exponent (`_calculate_arrhenius_exponent`). This value directly represents the responsiveness of biological reaction speed to temperature, and in the context of this empirical equation, may also be related to the methane potential of manure in storage and activity of the microbial population:

$$Arrh_exp\ g\ (CH_4\ kg^{-1}\ VS\ h^{-1}) = e^{Ln(A) - \frac{ACTIVATION_ENERGY}{(Gasconstant * manuretemperature)}}$$

[MN.MET.2]

When:

- Ln(A): The natural log of the Arrhenius parameter (`NATURAL_LOG_ARRHENIUS_CONSTANT` constant), set at 31.2 based on Petersen et al., 2024. This is an empirically-derived value determined based on observed manure CH₄ emission values.
- ACTIVATION_ENERGY: the apparent activation energy of methanogenesis in cattle slurry (J/mol), set at 81,000 J/mol, based on Elsgaard, Olsen, and Petersen, 2016.
- Gas constant: ideal gas constant, set at 8.314 J K/mol.
- Manure temperature (K): temperature of manure in storage.

Now we can calculate actual daily CH₄ emission, based on the total quantity of VS_d and VS_{nd} in stored manure. The basic equation, used to calculate CH₄ emissions for each VS fraction, is as follows:

$$CH_4\ emission\ from\ VS_{d\ or\ nd}\ (kg\ d^{-1}) = 24 * Arrh_exp * VS_{d\ or\ nd} * rate_factor$$

[MN.MET.3]

When:

- 24: conversion factor from hours to day.
- Arrh_exp: Arrhenius parameter for CH₄ emission rate (g CH₄ kg⁻¹ VS h⁻¹), calculated in [MN.MET.2].
- VS_{d or nd}: The mass (kg) of VS_d or VS_{nd} in manure in slurry storage.
- rate_factor: The unitless rate-correcting factor, set to 1 for VS_d and 0.01 for VS_{nd}.

The total daily CH₄ emission is equal to the sum of emissions from the VS_d and VS_{nd} fractions.

Calculate cover and flare methane emissions

`_calculate_cover_and_flare_methane`

The cover and flare option is applicable to slurry storage outdoor only. If the cover and flare option is selected, daily CH₄ emission from slurry storage is multiplied by a methane destruction efficiency value. The set value



for methane destruction efficiency is 81%, based on a white paper commissioned by Dairy Management, Inc on cover and flare efficiency (Wallace et al., 2023). The updated daily CH₄ emission (kg) from a cover and flare slurry storage is as follows:

$$\text{Daily storage CH}_4 \text{ (kg)} : \text{storage CH}_4 * \text{METHANE_DESTRUCTION_EFFICIENCY}$$

[MN.MET.4]

When:

- Storage CH₄ (kg): total daily kg of CH₄ emitted from stored manure, calculated in [MN.MET.3].
- METHANE_DESTRUCTION_EFFICIENCY: coefficient for destruction of methane by the flare, set to 0.81.

Calculate volatile solids losses

Daily emissions of CH₄ and CO₂ from slurry storage occur through microbial degradation of VS in slurry manure, among other processes (Petersen et al., 2024). Therefore, gaseous emissions from slurry storage result in a decrease in the quantity of VS in stored slurry. VS_d and VS_{nd} remaining in manure are updated separately according to their loss via CH₄ [MN.STO.4]. Here, we assume a fixed 1:3 molar ratio of CH₄ to CO₂ emissions from stored slurry from Petersen et al., 2024 to calculate the total amount of VS_d and VS_{nd} lost through CH₄ and CO₂ emissions based on the quantity of CH₄ emitted from each VS fraction.

The molar mass of CO₂ is 2.75 times that of CH₄, therefore, the total kg of VS loss per kg of CH₄ loss is 1 + (3 x 2.75) = 9.25 kg (or, 1 kg of VS loss from CH₄ + 8.25 kg of VS loss from CO₂). We use this value to calculate total VS loss based on the estimated emission of CH₄ (kg) from each VS fraction in storage.

$$\text{CH}_4 \text{ emission from VS}_{d \text{ or } nd} \text{ (kg)} * \text{METHANE_TO_METHANE_CARBON_DIOXIDE_RATIO} = \text{VS}_{d \text{ or } nd} \text{ loss (kg)}$$

[MN.STO.3]

When:

- CH₄ emission from VS_d or _{nd} (kg): total daily kg of CH₄ emitted from VS_d or VS_{nd}, calculated in [MN.MET.3].
- METHANE_TO_METHANE_CARBOXIDE_RATIO: default ratio of CH₄ + CO₂ kg emitted per CH₄ kg emitted from slurry storage, set to 9.25

Calculate ammonia emissions

_calculate_ammonia_emissions

Emission of NH₃-N from slurry storage is determined using equations from Rotz and Oenema, 2006, which are also utilized in the IFSM (Rotz, Corson, et al., 2023). Ammonia emissions are influenced by the quantity of TAN accumulated in manure storage, manure temperature, and manure storage surface area. First, we must derive the various parameters utilized in the calculation. This has already been outlined in the [Manure Handler](#) section.

Calculate nitrous oxide emissions _calculate_nitrous_oxide_emissions

N₂O emissions (kg N₂O-N) are based on the daily quantity of manure N loaded into storage, whether the manure storage is covered or uncovered. This method is based on Intergovernmental Panel on Climate



Change, 2019; however, it should be noted that the original IPCC, 2006 method is based on daily manure N excretion by animals, whereas the current method is based on manure N loading into storage, which may reflect upstream N losses from NH₃ emissions in housing, solid liquid separation, etc. The calculation is as follows:

$$N_2O - N \text{ emissions (kg)} = Received_N * N_2O \text{ factor}$$

[MN.NIT.1]

When:

- Received_N (kg): Quantity of manure total N loaded into storage on the current day
- N₂O factor: kg of N₂O-N emitted per kg of manure N added per day to storage, based on the following logic:
 - Cover type = crust OR cover; 0.005
 - Cover type = no cover; 0 (no N₂O emissions)

C. Output Variables

Received and accumulated outputs Manure storages in RuFaS report two types of outputs to OutputManager each day: received manure and stored manure.

Received manure Received manure outputs represent the quantity of manure mass and nutrients added to the manure storage on a single day. No nutrient losses from gas or other emissions/losses are reflected in these output values.

Stored manure Stored manure outputs represent the accumulated quantity of manure and nutrients present in storage on a single day. These values are the net quantity of mass/nutrients remaining each day after adding received manure values and subtracting any losses to gas emissions or other losses. In slurry storage processors, daily losses include CH₄, NH₃, and N₂O emissions. The order of operations in updating accumulated manure values is:

- Add received manure values to stored manure values
- Calculate gas emissions and total nutrient losses based on stored manure values
- Update stored manure values based on the day's nutrient losses. See the Manure composition update section for specific details on how nutrient gains and losses are accounted for on a daily timestep.

For slurry storage and all other storage processor types, the stored manure values (not received manure) are passed to the next processor in the chain (e.g. another storage, field application, export, etc.) when the storage time interval is complete.

Received manure In slurry storage processors, the following nutrient sources are represented in received manure values: ManureStream values, as received from the previous processor(s) in the manure management chain Precipitation water (kg), calculated in MN.STO.2 (if applicable), is added to the water value in ManureStream

Stored manure Below is a summary of updates to ManureStream variables representing the stored manure. Note that the formulas below may be a summarization of multiple steps detailed above, and are intended to provide an overview of what mass losses/gains are reflected in the value of each variable. Equations in the table below (Calculation column) are in the format of: updated stored manure value = yesterday's stored manure value + today's manure value +/- XYZ. The updated stored manure values reflect the total quantity of manure/nutrients in storage on a single day after accounting for all gains/losses that occurred on that day. Received manure simply refers to the manure being loaded into the manure storage each day.



Table 20: Manure storage variable calculations

Variable	Units	Calculation
water	kg	Stored manure water (kg) + received manure water (kg)
total_ammoniacal_nitrogen	kg	$\max(0, \text{stored manure ammoniacal nitrogen (kg)} + \text{received ammoniacal nitrogen (kg)} - \text{NH}_3\text{N emissions (kg)})$
nitrogen	kg	$\text{stored manure nitrogen (kg)} + \text{received manure nitrogen (kg)} - \text{NH}_3\text{N emissions (kg)} - \text{N}_2\text{O-N emissions (kg)}$
phosphorus	kg	$\text{stored manure phosphorus (kg)} + \text{received manure phosphorus (kg)}$
potassium	kg	$\text{stored manure potassium (kg)} + \text{received manure potassium (kg)}$
ash	kg	$\text{stored manure ash (kg)} + \text{received manure ash (kg)}$
non_degradable_volatile_solids		$\text{stored non-degradable volatile solids (kg)} + \text{received non-degradable volatile solids (kg)} - \text{VSnd loss (kg)}$
degradable_volatile_solids		$\text{stored degradable volatile solids (kg)} + \text{received degradable volatile solids (kg)} - \text{VSd loss (kg)}$
total_solids	kg	$\text{stored total solids (kg)} + \text{received total solids (kg)} - \text{VSd loss (kg)} - \text{VSnd loss (kg)}$
volume	m ³	$\text{stored volume (m}^3\text{)} + \text{received volume (m}^3\text{)} - \frac{\text{VSd loss (kg)} + \text{VSnd loss (kg)}}{\text{SLURRY_MANURE_DENSITY}}$

VIII. Anaerobic Lagoon

A. Introduction

Manure that is stored and managed at less than 5% dry matter is generally considered to be liquid manure. Liquid manure is generated by either dilution of raw or slurry manure, generally through the addition of wash or flush water, or removal of a portion of manure solids through solid liquid separation methods (mechanical separator, settling basin, etc.) or anaerobic digestion. Liquid manure is generally stored in a type of large, outdoor storage structure called an anaerobic lagoon, or simply a lagoon. Anaerobic lagoons are not simply structures in which to store manure. Lagoons facilitate biological breakdown of organic materials, which reduces volatile solids content and odor, though also increases N mineralization and loss as ammonia, particularly if the lagoon is uncovered. Accordingly, anaerobic lagoons have specific design and management requirements to facilitate biological treatment activity (Natural Resources Conservation Service (NRCS), 2017). Some characteristics that separate an anaerobic lagoon from slurry or liquid manure storage are:

- Greater storage capacity
- Less frequent and less complete emptying, resulting in longer solids/sludge retention time
- Storage of liquid rather than slurry manure
- Controlled volatile solids loading rate
- Lagoons are generally a lined or unlined in-ground basin, whereas slurry storage may be either in-ground or above-ground tanks or other structures

Implementation in RuFaS

In RuFaS, the underlying biological and gas emission methods are identical for slurry storages vs. anaerobic lagoons, as the biological process of organic matter breakdown is very similar between the two in reality.



However, the differences in size, dilution, management, and other factors differ between the two in reality, leading to generally greater GHG emissions from lagoons compared to slurry storages.

In the anaerobic lagoon submodule, accumulated manure in storage (i.e., held in the lagoon) is modeled on a daily timestep. Nutrient/mass gains from daily addition of manure (feces/urine, bedding, wash water) to storage, and precipitation volume entering storage, are tracked. Gas emissions are calculated daily based on the quantity of nutrients in stored manure, manure temperature, storage type, use of a cover, and storage duration. Manure composition is then updated according to net nutrient losses/gains. Manure accumulates in storage until the end of the user-defined storage interval is reached. However, quantities of manure may additionally be removed from storage according to the user-defined manure application schedule

Required User Inputs

Table 21: Required inputs for the anaerobic lagoon section (refreshed_manure_management.json)

Variable	Units	Description
Name	none	Unique identifier of the specific anaerobic lagoon configuration used.
Capacity	m ³	The volumetric capacity of the anaerobic lagoon, in m ³ . Note that this variable is a placeholder at this time, and does not influence model calculations.
Cover	The type of cover used with the anaerobic lagoon.	
Surface_area	m ²	The surface area of the anaerobic lagoon at the minimum operating level.
Storage_time_period	days	The number of days that manure is stored between emptying events. At the end of this interval, the manure storage is emptied completely.

Other inputs

Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

- water
- ammoniacal_nitrogen
- nitrogen
- phosphorus
- potassium
- ash
- non_degradable_volatile_solids
- degradable_volatile_solids
- total_solids
- volume

Expected Outputs



- storage_methane (kg): Daily emission of CH₄ from accumulated manure in an anaerobic lagoon.
- storage_ammonia (kg): Daily emission of NH₃ from accumulated manure an anaerobic lagoon.
- storage_nitrous_oxide (kg): Daily emission of N₂O from accumulated manure an anaerobic lagoon.

B. Methodology

Calculate manure temperature _determine_outdoor_storage_temperature

Temperature of stored manure is assumed to be equal throughout the entire mass of manure. In manure stored outdoors, manure temperature is assumed to be equal to air temperature, but is bounded to 0 to 35°C.

Calculate storage surface area Exposed surface area (m²) of the manure in storage is important in determining NH₃-N emissions, as well as in determining precipitation volume added to storage if the storage is not covered or indoors. Wherever possible, this value should be provided by the user if modeling a real farm. If farm-specific information is unavailable or the farm being modeled is theoretical, the surface area should be estimated using tools like [Animal Waste Management](#). However, the RuFaS team recognizes that minimizing required inputs is desirable, though a fixed storage surface area is undesirable due to the variability in storage structure size and surface area. With this, an equation was developed that estimates storage surface area based on the following assumptions:

- All manure excreted by animals on the farm enters the specified storage. At this time, the Manure module is not capable of assessing the proportion of manure excreted that is stored in the defined storages, therefore, all manure is assumed to be stored in the current storage, for the purposes of surface area estimation.
- The storage is 15 ft deep, with vertical walls.
- The storage receives 2500 mm of precipitation per year.
- Herd composition, and thus manure excretion, is fixed, and the number of animals in each life stage class is proportional to the number of mature cows.

A constant value was derived to calculate estimated manure excretion based on the number of mature cows housed on the farm (a user input). The average number of animals in each class was determined according to default RuFaS animal lifecycle inputs, and the total mass and volume of manure excreted by the herd was calculated. This resulted in an estimated daily herd-wide manure excretion of 168.6 kg or 0.118 m³ of manure per mature cow housed on the farm. The resulting equation is used to calculate storage surface area (m²).

$$surface_area(m^2) = \frac{(cow_num * MANURE_CONVERSION_CONSTANT * storage_time * FREEBOARD_CONSTANT)}{(DEPTH_CONSTANT - PRECIPITATION_CONSTANT)}$$

[MN.STO.1]

When:

- cow_num: user-inputted number of mature cows housed on the farm
- MANURE_CONVERSION_CONSTANT: Factor to estimate m³ of herd-wide manure produced per day per mature cow housed on the farm, set to 0.1175 m³.
- storage_time (days): user-inputted number of days that manure is stored in this storage for before being emptied
- FREEBOARD_CONSTANT: the volume allowance above the maximum volume of a slurry or liquid manure storage, set to 1.20 (20%).



- DEPTH.CONSTANT: value for slurry or liquid manure storage depth, set to 4.572 m (15 feet).
- PRECIPITATION.CONSTANT: The annual precipitation constant value, used only in determinatio

Calculate precipitation volume The use of covers has implications for inclusion or exclusion of precipitation volume, as well as for N₂O emissions. Four cover options exist for anaerobic lagoons.

- Cover
- Cover and flare
- Crust
- No cover

Detailed descriptions are outlined in the Slurry Storage section of this module.

Precipitation volume for anaerobic lagoons that are uncovered or have a crust is calculated as follows:

$$\text{Daily precipitation volume (m}^3\text{)} = \text{storage surface area (m}^2\text{)} * \text{precipitation (m)}$$

[MN.STO.2]

When:

- Storage surface area: the user-defined or model-estimated storage surface area (m²).
- Precipitation: the daily amount of precipitation (m).

Calculate methane emissions `_calculate_methane_emissions` We use an adaptation of a method originally conceived by Sommer, Petersen, and Moller, 2004 to calculate daily emissions of CH₄ from degradable and non-degradable VS in anaerobic lagoons. These equations focus on the degradation of degradable and non-degradable volatile solids (VS) present in the manure. Factors like degradable and non-degradable VS (VSd and VSnd) content in storage, temperature, and location (indoor/outdoor) affect estimated CH₄ emissions. We apply the original method from Sommer et al., 2022 with updated dairy manure Arrhenius and activation energy values from Elsgaard, Olsen, and Petersen, 2016 and Petersen et al., 2024. The same equation is utilized to calculate CH₄ emissions from VSd and VSnd, though the rate-correcting factor differs between the two.

First, we must calculate the value of the Arrhenius exponent (`_calculate_arrhenius_exponent`). This value directly represents the responsiveness of biological reaction speed to temperature, and in the context of this empirical equation, may also be related to the methane potential of manure in storage and activity of the microbial population:

$$Arrh_exp (g CH_4 kg^{-1} VS h^{-1}) = e^{Ln(A) - \frac{ACTIVATION_ENERGY}{(Gasconstant * manuretemperature)}}$$

[MN.MET.2]

When:

- Ln(A): The natural log of the Arrhenius parameter (`NATURAL_LOG_ARRHENIUS_CONSTANT`), set at 31.2 based on Petersen et al., 2024. This is an empirically-derived value determined based on observed manure CH₄ emission values.



- ACTIVATION_ENERGY: the apparent activation energy of methanogenesis in cattle slurry (J/mol), set at 81,000 J/mol, based on Elsgaard, Olsen, and Petersen, 2016.
- Gas constant: ideal gas constant, set at 8.314 J K/mol.
- Manure temperature (K): temperature of manure in storage.

Now we can calculate actual daily CH₄ emission, based on the total quantity of VS_d and VS_{nd} in stored manure. The basic equation, used to calculate CH₄ emissions for each VS fraction, is as follows:

$$CH_4 \text{ emission from } VS_{d \text{ or } nd} (kg \text{ d}^{-1}) = 24 * Arrh_exp * VS_{d \text{ or } nd} * rate_factor$$

[MN.MET.3]

When:

- 24: conversion factor from hours to day.
- Arrh_exp: Arrhenius parameter for CH₄ emission rate (g CH₄ kg⁻¹ VS h⁻¹), calculated in [MN.MET.2].
- S_d or S_{nd}: The mass (kg) of VS_d or VS_{nd} in manure in storage.
- rate_factor: The unitless rate-correcting factor, set to 1 for VS_d and 0.01 for VS_{nd}.

The total daily CH₄ emission is equal to the sum of emissions from the VS_d and VS_{nd} fractions.

Calculate cover and flare methane emissions _calculate_cover_and_flare_methane If the cover and flare option is selected, daily CH₄ emission from an anaerobic lagoon is multiplied by a methane destruction efficiency value. The set value for methane destruction efficiency is 81%, based on a white paper commissioned by Dairy Management, Inc. on cover and flare efficiency authored by Jim Wallace and co-authors. The updated daily CH₄ emission (kg) from a cover and flare lagoon is as follows:

$$Daily \text{ storage } CH_4 (kg) : storage \text{ } CH_4 * METHANE_DESTRUCTION_EFFICIENCY$$

[MN.MET.4]

When:

- Storage CH₄ (kg): total daily kg of CH₄ emitted from stored manure, calculated in [MN.MET.4].
- METHANE_DESTRUCTION_EFFICIENCY: destruction efficiency: coefficient for destruction of methane by the flare, set to 0.81.

Calculate volatile solids losses Daily emissions of CH₄ and CO₂ from slurry storage occur through microbial degradation of VS in slurry manure, among other processes (Petersen et al., 2024). Therefore, gaseous emissions from slurry storage result in a decrease in the quantity of VS in stored slurry.

VS_d and VS_{nd} remaining in manure are updated separately according to their loss via CH₄ (MN.STO.3). Here, we assume a fixed 1:3 molar ratio of CH₄ to CO₂ emissions from stored slurry from Petersen et al., 2024 to calculate the total amount of VS_d and VS_{nd} lost through CH₄ and CO₂ emissions based on the quantity of CH₄ emitted from each VS fraction.

The molar mass of CO₂ is 2.75 times that of CH₄, therefore, the total kg of VS loss per kg of CH₄ loss is 1 + (3 x 2.75) = 9.25 kg (or, 1 kg of VS loss from CH₄ + 8.25 kg of VS loss from CO₂). We use this value to calculate total VS loss based on the estimated emission of CH₄ (kg) from each VS fraction.



$$CH_4 \text{ emission from } VS_{d \text{ or } nd} (kg) * METHANE_TO_METHANE_CARBON_DIOXIDE_RATIO$$

[MN.STO.3]

When:

- CH₄ emission from VS_d or nd (kg): total daily kg of CH₄ emitted from VS_d or VS_{nd}, calculated in MN.MET.3
- METHANE_TO_METHANE_CARBON_DIOXIDE_RATIO: default ratio of CH₄ + CO₂ kg emitted per CH₄ kg emitted from an anaerobic lagoon, set to 9.25

Calculate ammonia emissions `_calculate_ammonia_emissions` Emission of NH₃-N from anaerobic lagoons is determined using equations from Rotz and Oenema, 2006, which are also utilized in the IFSM (Rotz, Corson, et al., 2023). Ammonia emissions are influenced by the quantity of total ammoniacal N (TAN) accumulated in manure storage, manure temperature, and manure storage surface area. First, we must derive the various parameters utilized in the calculation.

- First, we need to derive the value of the equilibrium coefficient Q for the NH₃ gas in the air for a given concentration of TAN in stored manure using Henry's law. Note that the concentration of NH₃ in the free atmosphere is assumed to be zero. Since Q is a function of the Henry's law coefficient K_h and a dissociation of ammonium coefficient K_a, we will calculate those first.

Henry's law coefficient (K_h)

$$K_h = 10^{\frac{1478}{\text{manure temperature}} - 1.69}$$

[MN.AMM.1]

When:

- Manure temperature (K): temperature of manure storage.

Dissociation coefficient of ammonium (K_a)

$$K_a = 1 + 10^{(0.09018 + \frac{2729.9}{\text{manure temperature}} - pH)}$$

[MN.AMM.2]

When:

- Manure temperature (K): temperature of manure storage.
- DEFAULT_STORED_MANURE_PH: the pH of the manure in storage, set to 7.5 by default

Equilibrium coefficient (Q)

$$Q = K_h * K_a$$



[MN.AMM.3]

When:

- K_h : Henry's law coefficient, calculated in [MN.AMM.1].
- K_a : Dissociation coefficient of ammonium, calculated in [MN.AMM.2].

- Next, the rate of $\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$ loss in kg N/m^2 from stored manure is calculated:

$$\text{NH}_3\text{N emission rate (kg N/m}^2\text{)} = \frac{(TAN * c * y)}{(r * M * Q)}$$

[MN.AMM.5]

When:

- TAN (kg N/m^2): Mass of ammoniacal N in stored manure
- c: time conversion constant (86400 s per d)
- y: manure density, set to 990 kg/m^3
- STORAGE_RESISTANCE: A constant value representing the sum of resistance of NH_3 transfer from solution to manure surface, and from manure surface to atmosphere, set at 23.1 s/m .
- Lastly, we calculate total $\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$ emissions (kg), based on the emission rate we just calculated and the manure storage surface area..

$$\text{NH}_3\text{N emissions (kg)} = \text{NH}_3\text{N_rate} * \text{soiled_surface_area}$$

[MN.AMM.7]

When:

- $\text{NH}_3\text{N_rate}$ (kg N/m^2): Rate of $\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$ loss (kg/m^2) from manure, calculated in [MN.AMM.5]
- $\text{soiled_surface_area}$ (m^2): the total surface area soiled with manure

Calculate nitrous oxide emissions `_calculate_nitrous_oxide_emissions`

N_2O emissions ($\text{kg N}_2\text{O-N}$) are based on the daily quantity of manure N loaded into the lagoon, and whether the lagoon is covered or uncovered. This method is based on Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, 2019; however, it should be noted that the original IPCC method is based on daily manure N excretion by animals, whereas the current method is based on manure N loading into storage, which may reflect upstream N losses from NH_3 emissions in housing, solid liquid separation, etc. The calculation is as follows:

$$\text{N}_2\text{ON emissions (kg)} = \text{Received_N} * \text{N}_2\text{O factor}$$

[MN.NIT.1]

When:



- Received.N (kg): Quantity of manure total N loaded into storage on the current day
- N₂O factor: kg of N₂O-N emitted per kg of manure N added per day to storage, based on the following logic:
 - Cover type = crust OR cover; 0.005
 - Cover type = no cover; 0 (no N₂O emissions)

Received manure

In anaerobic lagoon processors, the following nutrient sources are represented in received manure values:

- ManureStream values, as received from the previous processor(s) in the manure management chain
- Precipitation water (kg), calculated in MN.STO.2 (if applicable), is added to the water value in ManureStream

Stored manure

Below is a summary of updates to ManureStream variables representing the stored manure. Note that the formulas below may be a summarization of multiple steps detailed above, and are intended to provide an overview of what mass losses/gains are reflected in the value of each variable.

Equations in the calculation column of Table 20 are in the format of: updated stored manure value = yesterday's stored manure value + today's manure value +/- XYZ. The updated stored manure values reflect the total quantity of manure/nutrients in storage on a single day after accounting for all gains/losses that occurred on that day. Received manure simply refers to the manure being loaded into the manure storage each day.

Manure storages in RuFaS report two types of outputs to OutputManager each day: received manure and stored manure.

Received manure Received manure outputs represent the quantity of manure mass and nutrients added to the anaerobic lagoon on a single day. No nutrient losses from gas or other emissions/losses are reflected in these output values.

Stored manure Stored manure outputs represent the accumulated quantity of manure and nutrients present in storage on a single day. These values are the net quantity of mass/nutrients remaining each day after adding received manure values and subtracting any losses to gas emissions or other losses. In anaerobic lagoon processors, daily losses include CH₄, NH₃, and N₂O emissions. The order of operations in updating accumulated manure values is:

- Add received manure values to stored manure values
- Calculate gas emissions and total nutrient losses based on stored manure values
- Update stored manure values based on the day's nutrient losses. See the Manure composition update section for specific details on how nutrient gains and losses are accounted for on a daily timestep.

For anaerobic lagoons and all other storage processor types, the stored manure values (not received manure) are passed to the next processor in the chain (e.g. another storage, field application, export, etc.) when the storage time interval is complete.

C. Output Variables



Table 22: Manure storage variables and calculation formulas

Variable	Units	Description
water	kg	Stored manure water (kg) + received manure water (kg)
total_ammoniacal_nitrogen	kg	$\max(0, \text{stored ammoniacal nitrogen (kg)} + \text{received ammoniacal nitrogen (kg)} - \text{NH}_3\text{N emissions (kg)})$
nitrogen	kg	$\text{stored nitrogen (kg)} + \text{received nitrogen (kg)} - \text{NH}_3\text{N emissions (kg)} - \text{N}_2\text{O-N emissions (kg)}$
phosphorus	kg	$\text{stored phosphorus (kg)} + \text{received phosphorus (kg)}$
potassium	kg	$\text{stored potassium (kg)} + \text{received potassium (kg)}$
ash	kg	$\text{stored ash (kg)} + \text{received ash (kg)}$
non_degradable_volatile_solids		$\text{stored non-degradable VS (kg)} + \text{received non-degradable VS (kg)} - \text{VSnd loss (kg)}$
degradable_volatile_solids		$\text{stored degradable VS (kg)} + \text{received degradable VS (kg)} - \text{VSd loss (kg)}$
total_solids	kg	$\text{stored total solids (kg)} + \text{received total solids (kg)} - \text{VSd loss (kg)} - \text{VSnd loss (kg)}$
volume	m ³	$\text{stored volume (m}^3\text{)} + \text{received volume (m}^3\text{)} - \frac{\text{VSd loss (kg)} + \text{VSnd loss (kg)}}{\text{LIQUID_MANURE_DENSITY}}$

IX. Bedded Pack

A. Introduction

Traditional dairy housing systems typically involve concrete flooring and limited bedding, which can lead to cow discomfort, suboptimal health, and laborious manure management. Bedded pack pens aim to address these issues by providing a soft, comfortable, and dry bedding surface for cows, enhancing their comfort and overall well-being.

Bedded packs fall into one of two management methods: a traditional bedded pack, or a compost bedded pack. See [UW-Madison Dairyland Initiative Report](#) for further detail.

Though the names are often used interchangeably, note here that the primary difference between the two types is the presence or absence of active mixing, and the length of time between complete removal of the accumulated bedding/manure mixture from the pen.

Traditional bedded pack Traditional bedded packs, referred to here as simply “bedded packs”, are typically bedded using straw. Fresh material is added daily without any mixing activity, which causes the manure/bedding mix (pack) to compact and become anaerobic. The pack material is typically removed every 4 to 6 weeks.

Compost Bedded Pack Compost bedded packs are typically bedded with sawdust, shavings, or other fine, dense, absorbent material. Bedding is added daily, accompanied by mixing of the pack material to promote aeration and aerobic decomposition (composting). This composting action leads to the production of heat and microbial activity that promotes breakdown of organic components and reductions in moisture content, resulting in a drier and more stable pack. The pack material is typically removed after several months.

Implementation in RuFaS The two types of bedded pack are modeled differently in RuFaS as their decomposition conditions and thus emission profiles differ. Bedded packs, where mixing does not occur, promote anaerobic decomposition, whereas compost bedded packs promote aerobic decomposition through regular mixing and aeration of the pack. Sawdust or shavings bedded pens may be used in situations where pens are cleaned more frequently, e.g. weekly, but these pens are not considered to be bedded packs in RuFaS.



Required User Inputs

Table 23: Required inputs for the bedded pack section (refreshed_manure_management.json)

Variable	Definition (units)	Description
Name	none	Unique identifier of the specific bedded pack configuration used.
storage_time_period	days	The number of days that the manure/bedding pack accumulates in the pen before being removed and replaced with fresh bedding.
is_mixed	true/false	A boolean indicator for whether the bedded pack is routinely mixed to intentionally promote composting activity.

Other inputs

Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

- water
- ammoniacal_nitrogen
- nitrogen
- phosphorus
- potassium
- ash
- non_degradable_volatile_solids
- degradable_volatile_solids
- total_solids
- volume

Classes *Note:* that Bedded Pack inherits some behavior (functionality) from the base Storage class.

Class	Description
CompostBeddedPackBarn(Storage)	bedded_pack.py

Expected Outputs

- storage_methane (kg): Total mass of CH₄ emitted from the bedded pack each day.
- storage_ammonia_N (kg): Total mass of NH₃-N emitted from the bedded pack each day.
- storage_nitrous_oxide_N (kg): Total mass of N₂O-N emitted from the bedded pack each day.
- storage_nitrogen_leached (kg): Total mass of N leached from the bedded pack each day. Leached N is assumed to be lost to the environment, and is not captured in runoff that may enter a manure storage.



- carbon_decomposition (kg): the total quantity of manure C lost through microbial degradation of volatile solids.

B. Methodology

Calculate daily methane generation

Description: Calculates the daily mass of methane emitted from the bedded pack based on daily manure VS added to the bedded pack (through animal excretion and bedding addition) and an emission factor based on mixing activity and simulation average temperature (Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024).

Here and in other equations, 'daily' denotes the value associated with received manure added to the bedded pack on a specified simulation day.

Table 24: Methane conversion factor values for bedded pack pens, based on presence or absence of mixing and average annual air temperature.

Average air temperature (°C)					
Mixing, T/F	≤ 4.6 °C	4.7 - 5.8 °C	5.8 - 13.9 °C	14.0 - 25.1 °C	≥ 25.2 °C
Mixing	0.5	0.5	1.0	1.0	1.5
No mixing	21	26	37	41	74

$$\text{methane (kg)} = B_o * MCF * tVS$$

[MN.MET.6]

When:

- B_o = achievable methane generation constant (kg CH₄ per kg manure VS)
- Constant Value: 0.24 m³ CH₄/kg VS
- MCF = methane conversion factor (Table 22), based on simulation average ambient temperature
- tVS (kg) = daily mass (kg) of manure total volatile solids in the bedded pack manure, received from ManureStream(s)

Calculate carbon decomposition

Description: In addition to microbial processes that occur in anaerobic conditions, which generate primarily CH₄ and CO₂, carbon in the manure/bedding mixture is also degraded through aerobic microbial processes. This process is a function of substrate availability/degradability, temperature, moisture, aeration, and microbial population. This series of calculations is based on the IFSM composting simulation method (Bonifacio, Rotz, and Richard, 2017a; Bonifacio, Rotz, and Richard, 2017b). Simplifications/assumptions that have been made which diverge from the original method are explicitly noted below.

- First, we calculate the maximum decomposition rate per day, and decomposition rate of the slow fraction per day. We use the same equation for both rates, however, the temperature value used in calculating maximum decomposition rate is 60 °C, versus 30 °C in calculating slow fraction degradation. The maximum decomposition rate value is set to 0.04195 and the slow fraction decomposition rate is set to 0.00846, but the equations and set values are shown below for reference.



$$max_decomp_rate = EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE * (1.066^{DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE-10} - 1.21^{DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE-50})$$

[MN.STO.4]

When:

- EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE (unitless): The effectiveness of microbial decomposition rate per day, set to 0.00237
- DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE: temperature of the inner compost layer, set to 60 °C (reflective of temperature at which microbial growth, and thus decomposition, is maximized)

$$slow_decomp_rate = EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE * (1.066^{DEFAULT_LAYER_TEMPERATURE-10} - 1.21^{DEFAULT_LAYER_TEMPERATURE-50})$$

[MN.STO.5]

When:

- EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE (unitless): The effectiveness of microbial decomposition rate per day, set to 0.00237
 - DEFAULT_LAYER_TEMPERATURE: temperature of the pack layer, set to 30°C Setting the layer temperature to a constant value is a simplification as manure pack temperature is not modeled dynamically at this time.
- Second, we calculate the carbon decomposition rate per day (calculate_carbon_decomposition_rate). The value of this parameter is equal to 0.03876, but the equation and set values are included below for reference.

$$C_decomp_rate = (max_decomp_rate - slow_decomp_rate) * e^{FIRST_ORDER_DECAYING_COEFFICIENT * (DEFAULT_DAYS_SINCE_LAST_MIXING - DEFAULT_LAG_TIME)} + slow_decomp_rate$$

[MN.STO.6]

When:

- max_decomp_rate and slow_decomp_rate calculated with [MN.STO.4], set to 0.04195 and 0.00846, respectively
- FIRST_ORDER_DECAYING_COEFFICIENT: First-order decaying coefficient constant, set to 0.10
- DEFAULT_DAYS_SINCE_LAST_MIXING: number of days from the start of pack formation or last mixing event, set to 1 by default
- lag: lag time in days to reach maximum decomposition rate, set to 2



- Third, we calculate the anaerobic effect coefficient, related to the effect of the degree of aeration in the manure pack on decomposition. This value is set to 0.9664, but the equation and fixed values are provided below for reference.

$$\text{anaerobic_effect} = \frac{\text{oxygen_mole_fraction}}{\frac{\text{oxygen_half_saturation_constant} + \text{oxygen_mole_fraction}}{\text{oxygen_half_saturation_constant} + \text{oxygen_ambient_air_mole_fraction}}} * \frac{0.15}{0.02 + 0.15} * \frac{0.02 + 0.21}{0.21} = 0.9664$$

When:

- oxygen_mole_fraction: mole fraction of oxygen in the air within the bedded pack, unitless, set at 0.15. This is a simplification as oxygen content of the manure pack is not currently modeled.
 - oxygen_half_saturation_constant: the half-saturation constant, unitless, set at 0.02 by the original publication.
 - oxygen_ambient_air_mole_fraction: the mole fraction of oxygen in ambient air, unitless, set at 0.21 (ambient air is approximately 21% oxygen).
- Fourth, we calculate total carbon in the manure/bedding pack available for decomposition. Here we make some assumptions on the carbon content of manure degradable vs. non-degradable volatile solids. Degradable volatile solids, which originate from fecal excretion by animals, are considered to be 50% carbon by weight (Larney, Ellert, and Olson, 2011). Non-degradable volatile solids, which originate primarily from bedding addition, are assumed to contain 35% carbon by weight. The total carbon available is the sum of these two quantities.

$$\text{carbon_from_VS}_d \text{ (kg)} = \text{degradable_volatile_solids} * \text{DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD}$$

[MN.STO.7]**When:**

- degradable_volatile_solids: The degradable volatile solids (kg) in the daily manure added to the bedded pack.
- DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD: the carbon content (%) of manure degradable volatile solids, set to 50% by default.

$$\text{carbon_from_VS}_{nd} \text{ (kg)} = \text{non_degradable_volatile_solids} * \text{DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSND}$$

[MN.STO.8]**When:**

- nondegradable_volatile_solids: The non-degradable volatile solids (kg) in the daily bedding and manure added to the bedded pack.



- `DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD`: the carbon content (%) of manure degradable volatile solids, set to 35% by default.

$$total_carbon\ (kg) = carbon_from_VSnd + carbon_from_VSd$$

[MN.STO.9]

- Finally, we calculate total carbon decomposition in kg/d using the coefficients and values calculated in the steps above (`calculate_carbon_decomposition`):

$$total_carbon_decomposition\ (kg) = (total_carbon * C_decomp_rate * DEFAULT_MOISTURE_EFFECT_MICROBIAL_DECOMP * anaerobic_effect)$$

[MN.STO.10]

When:

- `total_carbon`: total carbon available in manure pack (kg); [MN.STO.9]
- `C_decomp_rate`: carbon decomposition rate per day; [MN.STO.6]
- `DEFAULT_MOISTURE_EFFECT_MICROBIAL_DECOMP`: The effect of moisture on microbial decomposition, set at 0.65. This is a simplification as moisture content of the manure pack is not currently modeled.
- `anaerobic_effect`: the anaerobic effect coefficient, related to the effect of the degree of aeration in the manure pack on decomposition. Set to 0.9664 by default.

Calculate total VS Loss The quantity of total and volatile solids remaining in the accumulated bedded pack must be updated according to estimated CH₄ and C decomposition losses. To do this, we calculate the total loss of VS through CH₄ emission and C decomposition. Loss of mass through CH₄ emissions is assumed to be equal to the mass of CH₄ emitted. Manure volatile solids are assumed to be 50% C, therefore, to determine total mass loss through C decomposition, we divide the mass of C decomposition by 0.50.

$$total_volatile_solids_loss\ (kg) = methane + \frac{total_carbon_decomposition}{0.50}$$

[MN.STO.11]

When:

- `methane` (kg): The daily methane loss, calculated with [MN.MET.6], based on the daily quantity of manure VS added to the bedded pack
- `total_carbon_decomposition` (kg): quantity of C lost through microbial decomposition (kg), calculated with [MN.STO.10], based on the daily quantity of manure VS added to the bedded pack

**Calculate N loss to ammonia** `_calculate_cbpb_ammonia_emission`

Manure nitrogen being deposited and accumulating in the bedded pack results in NH₃ emissions. Here we utilize an emission factor based on mixing activity (**hanson2024**) to estimate total kg of ammonia loss based on the daily manure N deposition by animals.

$$storage_ammonia_N \text{ (kg)} = daily_manure_N \text{ (kg)} * ammonia_coefficient$$

[MN.AMM.8]**When:**

- `daily_maure_N`: Daily kg of manure N added to the bedded pack
- `ammonia_coefficient`: kg of NH₃-N emitted per kg of manure N added per day to the bedded pack, based on the style of management:
 - Bedded pack (no mixing) = `AMMONIA_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT_WITH_UNTILLED_BEDDING` (0.25)
 - Compost bedded pack (mixing) = `AMMONIA_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT_WITH_TILLED_BEDDING` (0.50)

Calculate N loss to nitrous oxide `_calculate_cbpb_nitrous_oxide_emission`

In addition to NH₃-N emissions, manure nitrogen deposition in the bedded pack also results in N₂O emissions. Similar to NH₃, we estimate daily N₂O-N loss using an emissions factor from Hanson et al. (2024) based on the type of management used.

$$storage_nitrous_oxide_N \text{ (kg)} = daily_manure_N \text{ (kg)} * nitrous_oxide_coefficient$$

[MN.NIT.1]**When:**

- `daily_maure_N`: Daily kg of manure N added to the bedded pack
- `ammonia_coefficient`: kg of NH₃-N emitted per kg of manure N added per day to the bedded pack, based on the style of management:
 - Bedded pack (no mixing) = `NITROUS_OXIDE_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT_WITH_UNTILLED_BEDDING` (0.01)
 - Compost bedded pack (mixing) = `NITROUS_OXIDE_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT_WITH_TILLED_BEDDING` (0.07)

Calculate N loss to leaching `calculate_nitrogen_loss_to_leaching`

Manure nitrogen deposited in bedded packs may also be lost to leaching. Leaching of manure N may occur when fecal and urinary N are converted to nitrate in the soil beneath the bedded pack, if the pack is not concrete, lined, or otherwise sealed. Nitrate can then be carried away via water movement through the subsoil. Similar to NH₃ and N₂O, we estimate daily leaching-N loss using an emissions factor from Hanson et al. (2024), which is not influenced by management of the bedded pack (i.e., mixing activity).



$$storage_leached_N \text{ (kg)} = daily_manure_N \text{ (kg)} * LEACHING_COEFFICIENT$$

[MN.STO.12]**When:**

- daily_maure_N: Daily kg of manure N added to the bedded pack
- LEACHING_COEFFICIENT: kg of N leached per kg of manure N added per day to the open lot; set at 0.035.

C. Output Variables**Received and accumulated outputs**

Manure storages in RuFaS report two types of outputs to OutputManager each day: received manure and stored manure.

Received manure

Received manure outputs represent the quantity of manure mass and nutrients added to the anaerobic lagoon on a single day. No nutrient losses from gas or other emissions/losses are reflected in these output values.

Stored manure

Stored manure outputs represent the accumulated quantity of manure and nutrients present in storage on a single day. These values are the net quantity of mass/nutrients remaining each day after adding received manure values and subtracting any losses to gas emissions or other losses. In anaerobic lagoon processors, daily losses include CH₄, NH₃, and N₂O emissions. The order of operations in updating accumulated manure values is: Add received manure values to stored manure values Calculate gas emissions and total nutrient losses based on stored manure values Update stored manure values based on the day's nutrient losses. See the Manure composition update section for specific details on how nutrient gains and losses are accounted for on a daily timestep.

For anaerobic lagoons and all other storage processor types, the stored manure values (not received manure) are passed to the next processor in the chain (e.g. another storage, field application, export, etc.) when the storage time interval is complete.

Received manure

In anaerobic lagoon processors, the following nutrient sources are represented in received manure values:

- ManureStream values, as received from the previous processor(s) in the manure management chain
- Precipitation water (kg), calculated in **[MN.STO.2]** (if applicable), is added to the water value in ManureStream

Stored manure

Below is a summary of updates to ManureStream variables representing the stored manure. Note that the formulas below may be a summarization of multiple steps detailed above, and are intended to provide an overview of what mass losses/gains are reflected in the value of each variable.

Equations in the table below (Calculation column) are in the format of: updated stored manure value = yesterday's stored manure value + today's manure value +/- XYZ. The updated stored manure values reflect the total quantity of manure/nutrients in storage on a single day after accounting for all gains/losses that occurred on that day. Received manure simply refers to the manure being loaded into the manure storage each day.



Table 25: Calculated manure storage variables and their units

Variable	Units	Calculation
water	kg	Stored manure water (kg) + received manure water (kg)
total_ammoniacal_nitrogen	kg	$\max(0, \text{stored manure ammoniacal N} + \text{received ammoniacal N} - \text{NH}_3\text{N emissions})$
nitrogen	kg	Stored manure N + received manure N – NH ₃ -N – N ₂ O-N emissions
phosphorus	kg	Stored manure P + received manure P
potassium	kg	Stored manure K + received manure K
ash	kg	Stored manure ash + received manure ash
non_degradable_volatile_solids		Stored non-degradable VS – VS loss × (1.0 – degradable VS fraction)
degradable_volatile_solids		Stored degradable VS – VS loss × degradable VS fraction
total_solids	kg	Stored TS + received TS – VS loss
volume	m ³	Stored volume + received volume – $\left(\frac{\text{VS loss}}{\text{SOLID.MANURE.DENSITY}}\right)$



X. Open Lot

A. Introduction

Open or dry lot dairy systems are systems in which cows are housed outdoors in earthen or concrete pens. The open lot surface typically consists of natural or compacted soil covered with accumulated dry manure. Open lot pens often contain some form of shelter to provide shade and protection from harsh weather conditions, under which bedding may be applied, especially during winter. In addition to the dirt/manure pack lot, these systems also typically have a segregated feed feeding area, which may include a concrete apron that cows stand and deposit manure upon while eating. Manure deposited in this area may be managed differently from manure deposited on the lot surface.

To manage the manure on the lot surface, farmers commonly harrow the surface to spread out, break up, and mix fresh manure into the existing dry pack, to facilitate drying and create a standing and lying surface mainly consisting of dry manure solids. Harrowing is usually performed daily, which results in mixing of the soil/dry manure pack and fresh manure and urine. When cows deposit urine and manure on the lot surface, the dry climate and low humidity typical to regions where these systems are common facilitate rapid drying and ammonia (NH₃) volatilization from urine. Harrowing activity also promotes volatilization of NH₃ through mixing of fresh urine and manure. Though NH₃ losses may be high, the harrowing/spreading action also serves to create a lighter, more aerated pack that emits less methane (CH₄) than other manure storage methods, such as slurry or liquid manure storage; however, these same aerobic conditions can also lead to greater nitrous oxide (N₂O) emissions from the lot surface.

Manure is allowed to accumulate on the lot surface for several weeks to months, and may be either spread flat or partially piled in the pen during this period. Lots are cleaned out typically via scraping with large equipment 1-2 times per year. Manure removed from lots may be immediately field applied, stacked/piled until field application, composted, or managed in other ways. Of note is that, while the majority of manure on open lot dairies may be managed as a solid, open lot dairies with milking animals will also utilize a slurry or liquid manure storage to store, at a minimum, milking parlor waste. Feed apron waste, lot runoff, or other waste may also be stored as a liquid.

Implementation in RuFaS

In the Open Lot processor, we receive manure information from the animal module and manure management information from user inputs. Given weather data, we then calculate daily nutrient losses through CH₄, N₂O, and NH₃ emissions, as well as N leaching and C decomposition. We update the composition of the accumulated manure mix each day as manure and urine are added and nutrients are lost through the processes mentioned.

Important assumptions:

- Harrowing is assumed to be performed daily. At this time, differences in lot manure harrowing or piling frequency are not reflected in calculation of emissions/losses.
- Gas emissions in this processor are based on annual emissions factors that are extrapolated to a daily timestep, meaning that calculations are made based on daily excretion of manure VS or N, rather than accumulated quantities of the nutrients. With this, for N and NH₃ emissions for example, manure is assumed to lose all estimated NH₃-N on the day it is excreted. Manure N accumulation in lot manure is tracked, but accumulated manure N does not influence NH₃ emissions.



Required User Inputs

Table 26: Required inputs for the open lots section

Variable	Units	Description
storage.time.period	days	The interval in days that the open lot pen is cleaned out, i.e., the majority of manure, either already in piles or spread across the lot surface, is scraped or otherwise collected from the lot and removed from the pen.

Other inputs

Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

- water
- ammoniacal_nitrogen
- nitrogen
- phosphorus
- potassium
- ash
- non_degradable_volatile_solids
- degradable_volatile_solids
- total_solids
- volume

Classes

Table 27: Classes available in open lots.

	Description
Storage(OpenLot)	open_lot.py.

Note: that Open Lot inherits some behavior (functionality) from the base Storage class.

Expected Outputs

- storage_methane (kg): Total mass of CH₄ emitted from the open lot manure each day.
- storage_ammonia_N (kg): Total mass of NH₃-N emitted from the open lot manure each day.
- storage_nitrous_oxide_N (kg): Total mass of N₂O-N emitted from the open lot manure each day.



- `storage_nitrogen_leached` (kg): Total mass of N leached from the open lot manure each day. Leached N is assumed to be lost to the environment, and is not captured in lot runoff that may enter a manure storage.
- `carbon_decomposition` (kg): the total quantity of manure C lost through microbial degradation of volatile solids.

B. Methodology

Calculate methane conversion factor `calculate_ifsm_methane_emission`

Calculates the methane conversion factor for open lot manure given the ambient air temperature using an equation from IFSM (Rotz, Corson, et al., 2023). This method is an adaptation of the IPCC, 2006 tier 2 approach. Note that the MCF cannot be lower than 0.

$$MCF = \max\left(0, \frac{0.0625 * T - 0.25}{100}\right)$$

[MN.MET.5]

When:

- T = ambient air temperature, 0 to 30°C

Calculate daily methane generation `calculate_ifsm_methane_emission`

Calculates the daily mass of methane emitted from the open lot based on daily manure volatile solids (VS) added to lot manure (through animal excretion and bedding addition) and the emission factor calculated in [MN.MET.5].

Here and in other equations, 'daily' denotes the value associated with received manure added to the open lot on a specified simulation day.

$$\text{methane (kg)} = Bo * MCF * tVS * METHANE_FACTOR$$

[MN.MET.6]

When:

- Bo = achievable methane generation constant (kg CH₄ per kg manure VS)
- Constant Value: 0.24 m³ CH₄/kg VS
- MCF = methane conversion factor calculated in [MN.MET.5], based on daily ambient temperature
- tVS (kg) = daily mass (kg) of manure total volatile solids in the open lot pen, received from Manure-Stream(s)
- METHANE_FACTOR = 0.67; unit conversion factor for CH₄ volume to mass (kg).

Calculate carbon decomposition `calculate_carbon_decomposition`

In addition to microbial processes that occur in anaerobic conditions, which generate primarily CH₄ and CO₂, open lot manure C is also degraded through aerobic microbial processes. This process is a function of



substrate availability/degradability, temperature, moisture, aeration, and microbial population. This series of calculations is based on the IFSM composting simulation method, which is described in detail in Bonifacio, Rotz, and Richard, 2017a and Bonifacio, Rotz, and Richard, 2017b. Simplifications/assumptions that have been made which diverge from the original method are explicitly noted below.

- First, we calculate the maximum decomposition rate per day, and decomposition rate of the slow fraction per day. We use the same equation for both rates, however, the temperature value used in calculating maximum decomposition rate is 60°C, versus 30°C in calculating slow fraction degradation. The maximum decomposition rate value is set to 0.04195 and the slow fraction decomposition rate is set to 0.00846, but the equations and set values are shown below for reference.

$$max_decomp_rate = EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE * 1.066^{(DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE-10) - 1.21^{(DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE-50)}}$$

[MN.STO.4]

When:

- EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE (unitless): The effectiveness of microbial decomposition rate per day, set to 0.00237
- DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE: temperature of the inner compost layer, set to 60°C (reflective of temperature at which microbial growth, and thus decomposition, is maximized)

$$slow_decomp_rate = EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE * 1.066^{(DEFAULT_LAYER_TEMPERATURE-10) - 1.21^{(DEFAULT_LAYER_TEMPERATURE-50)}}$$

[MN.STO.5]

When:

- EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE (unitless): The effectiveness of microbial decomposition rate per day, set to 0.00237
- DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE: temperature of the inner compost layer, set to 30°C. Setting the layer temperature to a constant value is a simplification as manure pack temperature is not modeled dynamically at this time.

- Second, we calculate the carbon decomposition rate per day (calculate_carbon_decomposition_rate). The value of this parameter is equal to 0.03876, but the equation and set values are included below for reference.

$$C_decomp_rate = (max_decomp_rate - slow_decomp_rate) * e^{FIRST_ORDER_DECAYING_COEFFICIENT * (DEFAULT_DAYS_SINCE_LAST_MIXING - DEFAULT_LAG_TIME)} + slow_decomp_rate$$

[MN.STO.6]

When:



- max_decomp_rate and slow_decomp_rate calculated with **[MN.STO.4]**, set to 0.04195 and 0.00846, respectively
 - FIRST_ORDER_DECAYING_COEFFICIENT: First-order decaying coefficient constant, set to 0.10
 - DEFAULT_DAYS_SINCE_LAST_MIXING: number of days from the start of pack formation or last mixing event, set to 1 by default
 - lag: lag time in days to reach maximum decomposition rate, set to 2
- Third, we calculate the anaerobic effect coefficient, related to the effect of the degree of aeration in the manure pack on decomposition. This value is set to 0.9664, but the equation and fixed values are provided below for reference.

$$\text{anaerobic_effect} = \frac{\text{oxygen_mole_fraction}}{(\text{oxygen_half_saturation_constant} + \text{oxygen_mole_fraction})} * \frac{(\text{oxygen_half_saturation_constant} + \text{oxygen_ambient_air_mole_fraction})}{\text{oxygen_ambient_air_mole_fraction}} = \frac{0.15}{(0.02 + 0.15)} * \frac{(0.02 + 0.21)}{0.21} = 0.9664$$

When:

- oxygen_mole_fraction: mole fraction of oxygen in the air within the lot manure pack, unitless, set at 0.15. This is a simplification as oxygen content of the manure pack is not currently modeled.
 - oxygen_half_saturation_constant: the half-saturation constant, unitless, set at 0.02 by the original publication.
 - oxygen_ambient_air_mole_fraction: the mole fraction of oxygen in ambient air, unitless, set at 0.21 (ambient air is approximately 21% oxygen).
- Fourth, we calculate total carbon in the manure/bedding pack available for decomposition. Here we make some assumptions on the carbon content of manure degradable vs. non-degradable volatile solids. Degradable volatile solids, which originate from fecal excretion by animals, are considered to be 50% carbon by weight (Larney, Ellert, and Olson, 2011). Non-degradable volatile solids, which originate primarily from bedding addition, are assumed to contain 35% carbon by weight. The total carbon available is the sum of these two quantities.

$$\text{carbon_from_VSd (kg)} = \text{degradable_volatile_solids} * \text{DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD}$$

[MN.STO.7]**When:**

- degradable_volatile_solids: The degradable volatile solids (kg) in the daily manure added to the open lot.
- DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD: the carbon content (%) of manure degradable volatile solids, set to 50% by default.

$$\text{carbon_from_VSnd (kg)} = \text{non_degradable_volatile_solids} * \text{DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD}$$



[MN.STO.8]

When:

- `non_degradable_volatile_solids`: The non-degradable volatile solids (kg) in the daily manure added to the open lot.
- `DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD`: the carbon content (%) of manure non-degradable volatile solids, set to 35% by default.

$$total_carbon\ (kg) = carbon_from_VS_{nd} + carbon_from_VS_d$$

[MN.STO.9]

- Finally, we calculate total carbon decomposition in kg/d using the coefficients and values calculated in the steps above (`_apply_dry_matter_loss`):

$$total_carbon_decomposition\ (kg) = (total_carbon * C_decomp_rate * DEFAULT_MOISTURE_EFFECT_MICROBIAL_DECOMP * anaerobic_effect)$$

[MN.STO.10]

When:

- `total_carbon`: total carbon available in manure pack (kg); [MN.STO.9]
- `C_decomp_rate`: carbon decomposition rate per day; [MN.STO.10]
- `DEFAULT_MOISTURE_EFFECT_MICROBIAL_DECOMP`: The effect of moisture on microbial decomposition, set at 0.65. This is a simplification as moisture content of the manure pack is not currently modeled.
- `anaerobic_effect`: the anaerobic effect coefficient, related to the effect of the degree of aeration in the manure pack on decomposition. Set to 0.9664 by default.

Calculate total VS Loss The quantity of total and volatile solids remaining in the accumulated bedded pack must be updated according to estimated CH₄ and C decomposition losses. To do this, we calculate the total loss of VS through CH₄ emission and C decomposition. Loss of mass through CH₄ emissions is assumed to be equal to the mass of CH₄ emitted. Manure volatile solids are assumed to be 50% C, therefore, to determine total mass loss through C decomposition, we divide the mass of C decomposition by 0.50.

$$total_volatile_solids_{loss}\ (kg) = methane + \frac{total_carbon_decomposition}{0.50}$$

[MN.STO.11]

When:



- methane (kg): The daily methane loss, calculated with **[MN.MET.6]**, based on the daily quantity of manure VS added to the open lot
- total_carbon_decomposition (kg): quantity of C lost through microbial decomposition (kg), calculated with **[MN.STO.10]**, based on the daily quantity of manure VS added to the open lot

Calculate N loss to ammonia

_calculate_cbpb_ammonia_emission

Manure nitrogen being deposited and accumulating in the bedded pack results in NH₃ emissions. Here we utilize an emission factor based on mixing activity (Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024) to estimate total kg of ammonia loss based on the daily manure N deposition by animals.

$$storage_ammonia_N \text{ (kg)} = daily_manure_N * ammonia_coefficient$$

[MN.AMM.8]

When:

- daily_maure_N: Daily kg of manure N added to the open lot
- AMMONIA_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT_IN_OPEN_LOTS: kg of NH₃-N emitted per kg of manure N added per day to the open lot; set at 0.36.

Calculate N loss to nitrous oxide _calculate_cbpb_nitrous_oxide_emission In addition to NH₃-N emissions, manure nitrogen deposition in the bedded pack also results in N₂O emissions. Similar to NH₃, we estimate daily N₂O-N loss using an emissions factor from Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024) based on the type of management used.

$$storage_nitrous_oxide_N \text{ (kg)} = daily_manure_N * nitrous_oxide_coefficient$$

[MN.NIT.1]

When:

- daily_maure_N: Daily kg of manure N added to the open lot
- NITROUS_OXIDE_COEFFICIENT_IN_OPEN_LOTS: kg of N₂-O-N emitted per kg of manure N added per day to the open lot; set at 0.02.

Calculate N loss to leaching calculate_nitrogen_loss_to_leaching Manure nitrogen deposited in bedded packs may also be lost to leaching. Leaching of manure N may occur when fecal and urinary N are converted to nitrate in the soil beneath the bedded pack, if the pack is not concrete, lined, or otherwise sealed. Nitrate can then be carried away via water movement through the subsoil. Similar to NH₃ and N₂O, we estimate daily leaching-N loss using an emissions factor from Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024, which is not influenced by management of the bedded pack (i.e., mixing activity).

$$storage_leached_N \text{ (kg)} = daily_manure_N \text{ (kg)} * LEACHING_COEFFICIENT$$



[MN.STO.12]

When:

- `daily_maure_N`: Daily kg of manure N added to the open lot
- `LEACHING_COEFFICIENT`: kg of N leached per kg of manure N added per day to the open lot; set at 0.035.

C. Output Variables**Received and accumulated outputs**

Manure storages in RuFaS report two types of outputs to `OutputManager` each day: received manure and stored manure.

Received manure

Received manure outputs represent the quantity of manure mass and nutrients added to the manure storage on a single day. No nutrient losses from gas or other emissions/losses are reflected in these output values.

Stored manure

Stored manure outputs represent the accumulated quantity of manure and nutrients present in storage on a single day. These values are the net quantity of mass/nutrients remaining each day after adding received manure values and subtracting any losses to gas emissions or other losses. In open lot processors, daily losses include CH_4 , NH_3 , N leaching, and N_2O emissions. The order of operations in updating accumulated manure values is:

1. Add received manure values to stored manure values
2. Calculate gas emissions and total nutrient losses based on received manure values
3. Update stored manure values based on the day's nutrient losses. See the Manure composition update section for specific details on how nutrient gains and losses are accounted for on a daily timestep.

For open lot and all other storage processor types, the stored manure values (not received manure) are passed to the next processor in the chain (e.g. another storage, field application, export, etc.) when the storage time interval is complete.

Received manure

Received manure simply refers to the manure being loaded into the manure storage each day (i.e., deposited on the open lot surface). In open lot processors, the following nutrient sources are represented in received manure values: `ManureStream` values, as received from the previous processor(s) in the manure management chain. In open lot processors, which are placed first in the manure management chain as there are no intermediary steps between animal excretion and the open lot, this `ManureStream` instance typically represents manure and bedding received directly from the Animal module. Daily precipitation volume/mass is not currently represented in received open lot manure (i.e., precipitation falling onto the lot each day is not represented in the received manure outputs representing nutrient/mass/water additions to the lot each day).

Stored manure

Below is a summary of updates to `ManureStream` variables representing the stored manure. Note that the formulas below may be a summarization of multiple steps detailed above, and are intended to provide an overview of what mass losses/gains are reflected in the value of each variable.

Equations in the table below (Calculation column) are in the format of: updated stored manure value = yesterday's stored manure value + today's manure value +/- XYZ. The updated stored manure values reflect the total quantity of manure/nutrients in storage on a single day after accounting for all gains/losses that occurred on that day.



Table 28: Manure composition variables and calculations after volatile solids loss

Variable	Units	Calculation
water	kg	Stored manure water (kg) + received manure water (kg)
total_ammoniacal_nitrogen	kg	$\max(0, \text{stored ammoniacal nitrogen (kg)} + \text{received ammoniacal nitrogen (kg)} - \text{NH}_3\text{N emissions (kg)})$
nitrogen	kg	$\text{stored nitrogen (kg)} + \text{received nitrogen (kg)} - \text{NH}_3\text{-N emissions (kg)} - \text{N}_2\text{O-N emissions (kg)}$
phosphorus	kg	stored phosphorus (kg) + received phosphorus (kg)
potassium	kg	stored potassium (kg) + received potassium (kg)
ash	kg	stored ash (kg) + received ash (kg)
non_degradable_volatile_solids	kg	$\text{stored non-degradable volatile solids (kg)} - \text{total volatile solids loss (kg)} \times (1.0 - \text{degradable volatile solids fraction})$
degradable_volatile_solids		$\text{stored degradable volatile solids (kg)} - \text{total volatile solids loss (kg)} \times \text{degradable volatile solids fraction}$
total_solids	kg	$\text{stored total solids (kg)} + \text{received total solids (kg)} - \text{total volatile solids loss (kg)}$
volume	m ³	$\text{stored volume (m}^3\text{)} + \text{received volume (m}^3\text{)} - \frac{\text{total volatile solids loss (kg)}}{\text{SOLID_MANURE_DENSITY}}$

¹ The "Max(0,)" notation prevents the ammoniacal N value from becoming negative. This is especially important early in a simulation when accumulated manure quantities that are very small compared to the fixed surface area value can lead to high ammonia emissions.

² $\text{degradable_volatile_solids_frac} = \text{received manure degradable_volatile_solids} / \text{received manure total_volatile_solids}$

XI. Composting

A. Introduction

Composting is a method of treating manure in which solid manure, generally with bedding or other carbon-rich material added, is purposefully managed in order to promote microbial decomposition. This naturally occurring decomposition process results in losses of both water and organic matter, resulting in a smaller volume and mass of manure the farm is required to store and handle. Composting also helps to stabilize manure by killing pathogens and weed seeds via heat generated from the decomposition process, and reduced odors. Finished compost is a useful end-product (like all well-managed manure) that can be land-applied, sold, or otherwise exported.

To promote optimal conditions for microbial decomposition, compost requires airflow through the pile to prevent anaerobic conditions from forming. While turning is the traditional way to achieve this, several methods to accomplish the necessary aeration of compost exist on farms today.

Implementation in RuFaS The following composting methods are represented in RuFaS:

- **Static pile:** material to be composted is piled and not turned/moved throughout the composting process. Aeration is maintained using either bulking agents to create airspace in the pile, or through forced air introduction via pipes.
- **Intensive windrow:** material to be composted is piled into long rows that are regularly turned to redistribute moisture, nutrients, and air through the pile.
- **Passive windrow:** material to be composted is piled into long rows, but is not regularly turned, and instead relies on passive air diffusion to aerate the pile.
- **In-vessel:** material to be composted is loaded into a large vessel, often a drum, which is mechanically rotated to promote uniform air circulation and heating.



At this time, turning frequency, pile composition, composting duration, C:N ratio, and other factors do not directly affect emissions or nutrient loss calculations. Only the general composting method and the basic composition (kg of N, volatile solids, etc.) of material added to the pile is factored into this submodule's calculations at this time.

Required User Inputs

Table 29: Required inputs for the composting section (refreshed_manure_management.json)

Variable	Definition (units)	Description
Name	none	Unique identifier of the specific handler configuration used.
Storage_time_period	days	The number of days that manure is stored between emptying events. At the end of this interval, the manure storage is emptied completely.
composting_type	static pile, passive windrow, intensive windrow, or in-vessel	The type of method used for composting

Other inputs

Instance(s) of a ManureStream that represent(s) manure being loaded into the manure storage on a single day. ManureStream instances include the following variables (all in kg except for volume, m³)

- water
- ammoniacal_nitrogen
- nitrogen
- phosphorus
- potassium
- ash
- non_degradable_volatile_solids
- degradable_volatile_solids
- total_solids
- volume

Expected Outputs

- storage_methane (kg): Total mass of CH₄ emitted from the compost each day.
- storage_ammonia_N (kg): Total mass of NH₃-N emitted from the compost each day.
- storage_nitrous_oxide_N (kg): Total mass of N₂O-N emitted from the compost each day.
- storage_nitrogen_leached (kg): Total mass of N leached from the compost each day. Leached N is assumed to be lost to the environment, and is not captured in runoff that may enter a manure storage.
- carbon_decomposition (kg): the total quantity of manure C lost through microbial degradation of volatile solids.



B. Methodology

Calculate daily methane generation `_calculate_composting_methane_emissions` Calculates the daily mass of methane emitted from the compost based on manure volatile solids (VS) added to compost (from animal excretion and bedding addition) and an emission factor based on composting method and simulation average temperature described in Table 1 (Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024).

Note here and in other equations, 'daily' denotes the value associated with received manure added to the compost on a specified simulation day.

Table 30: Methane conversion factor values for compost pens, based on composting method and average annual air temperature.

Composting method	Average air temperature (°C)		
	0 - 10 °C	10 - 18 °C	>18 °C
In-vessel	0.5	0.5	0.5
Static pile	1.0	2.0	2.5
Intensive windrow	0.5	1.0	1.5
Passive windrow	1.0	2.0	2.5

$$\text{methane (kg)} = B_o * MCF * tVS$$

[MN.MET.6]

When:

- B_o = achievable methane generation constant (kg CH₄ per kg manure VS)
 - Constant Value: 0.24 m³ CH₄/kg VS
- MCF = methane conversion factor (Table 27), based on simulation average ambient temperature
- tVS (kg) = daily mass (kg) of manure total volatile solids added to compost, received from Manure-Stream(s)

Calculate carbon decomposition

`calculate_carbon_decomposition`

Carbon in the compost material is degraded through primarily aerobic microbial processes. This process is a function of substrate availability/degradability, temperature, moisture, aeration, and microbial population. This series of calculations is based on the IFSM composting simulation method, which is described in detail in Bonifacio, Rotz, and Richard, 2017a and Bonifacio, Rotz, and Richard, 2017b. Simplifications/assumptions that have been made which diverge from the original method are explicitly noted below.

- First, we calculate the maximum decomposition rate per day, and decomposition rate of the slow fraction per day. We use the same equation for both rates, however, the temperature value used in calculating maximum decomposition rate is 60°C, versus the actual ambient air temperature in calculating slow fraction degradation. The maximum decomposition rate value is set to 0.04195, but the equation is shown below for reference.



$$max_decomp_rate = EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE * (1.066^{(DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE-10)} - 1.21^{(DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE-50)})$$

[MN.STO.4]

- EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE (unitless): The effectiveness of microbial decomposition rate per day, set to 0.00237
- DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE: temperature of the inner compost layer, set to 60°C (reflective of temperature at which microbial growth, and thus decomposition, is maximized)

$$slow_decomp_rate = EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE * \frac{1.066^{(daily_temperature-10)} - 1.21^{(daily_temperature-50)}}{1.066^{(daily_temperature-10)} - 1.21^{(daily_temperature-50)}}$$

[MN.STO.5]

- EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE (unitless): The effectiveness of microbial decomposition rate per day, set to 0.00237
 - daily_temperature: average ambient air temperature on a single day (°C).
- Second, we calculate the carbon decomposition rate per day (calculate_carbon_decomposition_rate). The value of this parameter is equal to 0.03876, but the equation and set values are included below for reference.

$$C_decomp_rate = (max_decomp_rate - slow_decomp_rate) * e^{(FIRST_ORDER_DECAYING_COEFFICIENT * (DEFAULT_DAYS_SINCE_LAST_MIXING - DEFAULT_LAG_TIME))} + slow_decomp_rate$$

[MN.STO.6]

- max_decomp_rate and slow_decomp_rate calculated with **[MN.STO.4]** and **[MN.STO.5]**
 - FIRST_ORDER_DECAYING_COEFFICIENT: First-order decaying coefficient constant, set to 0.10
 - DEFAULT_DAYS_SINCE_LAST_MIXING: number of days from the start of composting or last turning/mixing event, set to 1 (i.e., assuming daily mixing)
 - lag: lag time in days to reach maximum decomposition rate, set to 2
- Third, we calculate the anaerobic effect coefficient, related to the effect of the degree of aeration in the manure pack on decomposition. This value is set to 0.9664, but the equation and fixed values are provided below for reference.

$$anaerobic_effect = \left(\frac{oxygen_mole_fraction}{(oxygen_half_saturation_constant + oxygen_mole_fraction)} \right) * \left(\frac{(oxygen_half_saturation_constant + oxygen_ambient_air_mole_fraction)}{oxygen_ambient_air_mole_fraction} \right) = \left(\frac{0.15}{(0.02+0.15)} \right) * \left(\frac{(0.02+0.21)}{0.21} \right) = 0.9664$$



- oxygen_mole_fraction: mole fraction of oxygen in the air within the windrow, unitless, set at 0.15. This is a simplification as oxygen content of the manure pack is not currently modeled.
 - oxygen_half_saturation_constant: the half-saturation constant, unitless, set at 0.02 by the original publication.
 - oxygen_ambient_air_mole_fraction: the mole fraction of oxygen in ambient air, unitless, set at 0.21 (ambient air is approximately 21% oxygen).
- Fourth, we calculate total carbon in the compost material available for decomposition. Here we make some assumptions on the carbon content of manure degradable vs. non-degradable volatile solids. Degradable volatile solids, which originate from fecal excretion by animals, are considered to be 50% carbon by weight (Larney, Ellert, and Olson, 2011). Non-degradable volatile solids, which originate primarily from bedding addition, are assumed to contain 35% carbon by weight. The total carbon available is the sum of these two quantities.

$$\text{carbon_from_VSd (kg)} = \text{degradable_volatile_solids} * \text{DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD}$$

[MN.STO.7]

- degradable_volatile_solids: The degradable volatile solids (kg) in the daily manure added to the compost.
- DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD: the carbon content (%) of manure degradable volatile solids, set to 50% by default.

$$\text{carbon_from_VSnd (kg)} = \text{non_degradable_volatile_solids} * \text{DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSND}$$

[MN.STO.8]

- non_degradable_volatile_solids: The non-degradable volatile solids (kg) in the daily bedding and manure added to the compost.
- DEFAULT_CARBON_AVAILABLE_IN_VSND: the carbon content (%) of manure non-degradable volatile solids, set to 35% by default.

$$\text{total_carbon (kg)} = \text{carbon_from_VSnd} + \text{carbon_from_VSd}$$

[MN.STO.9]

- Finally, we calculate total carbon decomposition in kg/d using the coefficients and values calculated in the steps above (calculate_carbon_decomposition):

$$\text{total_carbon_decomposition (kg)} = (\text{total_carbon} * \text{C_decomp_rate} * \text{DEFAULT_MOISTURE_EFFECT_MICROBIAL_DECOMP} * \text{anaerobic_effect})$$

**[MN.STO.10]**

- total_carbon: total carbon available in compost (kg); **[MN.STO.9]**
- C_decomp_rate: carbon decomposition rate per day; **[MN.STO.6]**
- DEFAULT_MOISTURE_EFFECT_MICROBIAL_DECOMP: The effect of moisture on microbial decomposition, set at 0.65. This is a simplification as moisture content of the compost is not currently modeled.
- anaerobic_effect: the anaerobic effect coefficient, related to the effect of the degree of aeration in the compost on decomposition. Set to 0.9664 by default.

Calculate total VS loss _apply_dry_matter_loss

The quantity of total and volatile solids remaining in the compost each day must be updated according to estimated CH₄ and C decomposition losses. To do this, we calculate the total daily loss of VS through CH₄ emission and C decomposition. Loss of mass through CH₄ emissions is assumed to be equal to the mass of CH₄ emitted. Manure volatile solids are assumed to be 50% C, therefore, to determine total mass loss through C decomposition, we divide the mass of C decomposition by 0.50.

$$total_volatile_solids_loss\ (kg) = methane + \left(\frac{total_carbon_decomposition}{0.50} \right)$$

[MN.STO.11]

- methane (kg): The daily methane loss, calculated with **[MN.MET.6]**, based on the daily quantity of manure VS added to the compost
- total_carbon_decomposition (kg): quantity of C lost through microbial decomposition (kg), calculated with **[MN.STO.10]**, based on the daily quantity of manure VS added to the compost

Calculate N loss to ammonia**_calculate_composting_ammonia_emissions**

Description: Manure nitrogen being added to and accumulating in the compost results in NH₃ emissions. Here we utilize daily manure N addition to compost and an emission factor based on composting method (Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024) to estimate total kg of NH₃-N loss.

Table 31: NH₃-N emission factors for compost by composting method.

Composting method	kg NH ₃ -N emitted per kg of N added to compost
In-vessel	0.45
Static pile	0.50
Intensive windrow	0.50
Passive windrow	0.45

$$storage_ammonia_N\ (kg) = daily_manure_N\ (kg) * ammonia_coefficient$$

[MN.AMM.8]



- `daily_maure_N`: Daily kg of manure N added to compost
- `ammonia_coefficient`: kg of $\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$ emitted per kg of manure N added per day to compost, based on the composting method

Calculate N loss to nitrous oxide

`_calculate_nitrous_oxide_emissions`

Description: In addition to $\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$ emissions, nitrogen added to and accumulating in the compost also results in N_2O emissions. Similar to NH_3 , here we utilize daily manure N addition to compost and an emission factor based on composting method (Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024) to estimate total kg of $\text{N}_2\text{O} - \text{N}$ loss.

Composting method	kg $\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$ emitted per kg of N added to compost
In-vessel	0.006
Static pile	0.010
Intensive windrow	0.005
Passive windrow	0.005

$$\text{storage_nitrous_oxide_N (kg)} = \text{daily_manure_N (kg)} * \text{nitrous_oxide_coefficient}$$

[MN.NIT.1]

- `daily_maure_N`: daily kg of manure N added to the compost
- `nitrous_oxide_coefficient`: kg of $\text{N}_2\text{O} - \text{N}$ emitted per kg of manure N added per day to compost, based on the composting method

Calculate N loss to leaching `calculate_nitrogen_loss_to_leaching`

Description: Nitrogen in compost may also be lost to leaching. Leaching of compost N may occur when fecal and urinary N are converted to nitrate in the soil beneath the compost, if the compost is not contained in a vessel. Nitrate can then be carried away via water movement through the subsoil. Similar to NH_3 and N_2O , we use daily manure N addition to compost and an emission factor based on composting method (Hanson, Itle, and Edquist, 2024) to estimate total kg of leaching N loss.

Table 32: $\text{N}_2\text{O-N}$ emission factors for compost by composting method.

Composting method	kg $\text{NH}_3\text{-N}$ emitted per kg of N added to compost
In-vessel	0.00
Static pile	0.06
Intensive windrow	0.06
Passive windrow	0.04



$$storage_leached_N \text{ (kg)} = daily_manure_N \text{ (kg)} * leaching_coefficient$$

[MN.STO.12]

- `daily_maure_N`: daily kg of manure N added to the bedded pack
- `leaching_coefficient`: kg of N leached per kg of manure N added per day to compost, based on the composting method

C. Output Variables

Received and accumulated outputs

Manure storages in RuFaS report two types of outputs to `OutputManager` each day: received manure and stored manure.

Received manure

Received manure outputs represent the quantity of manure mass and nutrients added to the manure storage on a single day. No nutrient losses from gas or other emissions/losses are reflected in these output values.

Stored manure

Stored manure outputs represent the accumulated quantity of manure and nutrients present in storage on a single day. These values are the net quantity of mass/nutrients remaining each day after adding received manure values and subtracting any losses to gas emissions or other losses. In composting processors, daily losses include CH_4 , NH_3 , N leaching, and N_2O emissions. The order of operations in updating accumulated manure values is:

1. Add received manure values to stored manure values
2. Calculate gas emissions and total nutrient losses based on received manure values
3. Update stored manure values based on the day's nutrient losses. See the Manure composition update section for specific details on how nutrient gains and losses are accounted for on a daily timestep.

For composting and all other storage processor types, the stored manure values (not received manure) are passed to the next processor in the chain (e.g. another storage, field application, export, etc.) when the storage time interval is complete.

Manure composition update

Received manure

In composting processors, the following nutrient sources are represented in received manure values: `ManureStream` values, as received from the previous processor(s) in the manure management chain. For composting processors, these `ManureStream` instance(s) typically represent an accumulated quantity of manure from an open lot or bedded pack, daily/weekly cleanout of the manure/bedding mix generated by other pen types, or daily addition of separated manure solids. Daily precipitation volume/mass is not currently represented in received manure added to compost (i.e., precipitation falling each day is not represented in the received manure outputs representing nutrient/mass/water additions to compost each day).

Stored manure

Below is a summary of updates to `ManureStream` variables representing the stored manure. Note that the formulas below may be a summarization of multiple steps detailed above, and are intended to provide an overview of what mass losses/gains are reflected in the value of each variable.

Equations in the table below (Calculation column) are in the format of: updated stored manure value = yesterday's stored manure value + today's manure value +/- XYZ. The updated stored manure values reflect the total quantity of manure/nutrients in storage on a single day after accounting for all gains/losses that occurred on that day.



Table 33: Manure pool calculations after solids loss

Variable	Units	Calculation
water	kg	Stored manure water (kg) + received manure water (kg)
total_ammoniacal_nitrogen	kg	$\max(0, \text{stored ammoniacal nitrogen (kg)} + \text{received ammoniacal nitrogen (kg)} - \text{NH}_3\text{N emissions (kg)})$
nitrogen	kg	$\text{stored nitrogen (kg)} + \text{received nitrogen (kg)} - \text{NH}_3\text{-N emissions (kg)} - \text{N}_2\text{O-N emissions (kg)}$
phosphorus	kg	$\text{stored phosphorus (kg)} + \text{received phosphorus (kg)}$
potassium	kg	$\text{stored potassium (kg)} + \text{received potassium (kg)}$
ash	kg	$\text{stored ash (kg)} + \text{received ash (kg)}$
non_degradable_volatile_solids	kg	$\text{stored non-degradable volatile solids (kg)} - \text{total volatile solids loss (kg)} \times (1.0 - \text{degradable volatile solids fraction})$
degradable_volatile_solids		$\text{stored degradable volatile solids (kg)} - \text{total volatile solids loss (kg)} \times \text{degradable volatile solids fraction}$
total_solids	kg	$\text{stored total solids (kg)} + \text{received total solids (kg)} - \text{total volatile solids loss (kg)}$
volume	m ³	$\text{stored volume (m}^3\text{)} + \text{received volume (m}^3\text{)} - \frac{\text{total volatile solids loss (kg)}}{\text{SOLID_MANURE_DENSITY}}$

¹ The "Max(0,)" notation prevents the ammoniacal N value from becoming negative. This is especially important early in a simulation when accumulated manure quantities that are very small compared to the fixed surface area value can lead to high ammonia emissions.

² $\text{degradable_volatile_solids_frac} = \text{received manure degradable_volatile_solids} / \text{received manure total_volatile_solids}$

XII. Key Constants

Table 34: The key constants for all equations in the Manure Module

Section	Variable	Value	Definition
Anaerobic Lagoon	ACTIVATION_ENERGY	81,000 J/mol	Apparent activation energy of methanogenesis in dairy manure.
	DEFAULT_STORED_MANURE_PH	7.5	Default pH of manure in slurry storage or anaerobic lagoon.
	FREEBOARD_CONSTANT	1.2	20% volume allowance above max volume if surface area is not user-defined.
	DEPTH_CONSTANT	4.572	Depth of slurry/liquid manure storage used for surface area calculation (m).
	PRECIPITATION_CONSTANT	0.25	Annual precipitation constant for determining storage surface area (m).
	MANURE_CONVERSION_CONSTANT	0.1175	Factor to estimate manure volume per cow per day (m ³).
	METHANE_DESTRUCTION_EFFICIENCY	0.81	Percent methane destroyed with cover and flare system.
	METHANE_TO_METHANE _CARBON_DIOXIDE_RATIO	9.25 kg	Mass ratio of CO ₂ + CH ₄ to CH ₄ from storage (Petersen et al., 2024).
	NATURAL_LOG_ARRHENIUS _CONSTANT	31.2 g CH ₄ /kg VS/h	Log of Arrhenius parameter for methane emissions from stored manure.
Animal Manure Connection	STORAGE_RESISTANCE	23.1	Default resistance to ammonia volatilization (s/m).
	SLURRY_MANURE_DENSITY	990 kg/m ³	Default density of manure as excreted.
Bedded Pack	AMMONIA_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT _WITH_UNTILLED_BEDDING	0.25	Ammonia emission coefficient (no mixing).
	AMMONIA_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT _WITH_TILLED_BEDDING	0.5	Ammonia emission coefficient (with mixing).

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Section	Variable	Value	Definition
Manure Handler	DEFAULT_DAYS_SINCE_LAST_MIXING	1 d	Days since last mixing, for C decomposition.
	NITROUS_OXIDE_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT_WITH_UNTILLED_BEDDING	0.01	N ₂ O-N emitted per kg of manure N/day (no mixing).
	NITROUS_OXIDE_EMISSION_COEFFICIENT_WITH_TILLED_BEDDING	0.07	N ₂ O-N emitted per kg of manure N/day (with mixing).
	HOUSING_SPECIFIC_CONSTANT	260.0 s/m	Default constant for ammonia emissions from housing.
	DEFAULT_PH_FOR_HOUSING_AMMONIA	7.7	Default pH for manure on housing floors.
	MILKING_FRESH_WATER_USE_RATE	30 L/animal/day	Milking water use rate per animal.
	WATER_DENSITY_KG_PER_M3	0.997 kg/m ³	Default water density.
	CARBON_DIOXIDE_MOLAR_MASS	44.01 g/mol	Molar mass of CO ₂ .
Slurry Storage	CARBON_DIOXIDE_TO_METHANE_RATIO	4 to 6	Volumetric ratio of CO ₂ to CH ₄ during digestion.
	IDEAL_GAS_LAW_R	0.0821 L atm/mol K	Ideal gas law constant.
	METHANE_MOLAR_MASS	16.04 g/mol	Molar mass of CH ₄ .
	TAN_INCREASE_FACTOR	1.60	TAN increase from anaerobic digestion (unitless).
Bedded Pack, Open Lots	DEFAULT_LAYER_TEMPERATURE	30 °C	Default layer temperature for decomposition.
Bedded Pack, Open Lots, Composting	DECOMPOSITION_TEMPERATURE	60 °C	Temperature for peak microbial activity.
	DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSD	0.5	Carbon content of degradable VS.
	DEFAULT_CARBON_FRACTION_AVAILABLE_IN_VSND	0.35	Carbon content of non-degradable VS.
	DEFAULT_MOISTURE_EFFECT_MICROBIAL_DECOMP	0.65	Moisture effect on microbial decomposition.
	DEFAULT_LAG_TIME	2 d	Lag time for C decomposition.

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Section	Variable	Value	Definition
	EFFECTIVE_MICROBIAL_DECOMP_RATE	0.00237	Microbial decomposition rate (unitless).
	FIRST_ORDER_DECAYING_COEFFICIENT	0.01	First-order decay coefficient.
	LEACHING_COEFFICIENT	–	N leached per kg manure N/day.
Open Lots, Composting	DEFAULT_DAYS_SINCE_LAST_MIXING	1 d	Days since last harrow event.
Slurry Storage, Bedded Pack, Open Lots, Composting	ACHIEVABLE_METHANE_EMISSION	0.24 m ³ CH ₄ /kg VS	Achievable methane generation.
	–	–	–
Separators, Bedded Pack, Open Lots, Composting	SOLID_MANURE_DENSITY	700 kg/m ³	Default solid manure density.
	LIQUID_MANURE_DENSITY	1000 kg/m ³	Default liquid manure density.



XIII. Abbreviations

Table 35: Common abbreviations used throughout this document

Abbreviation	Full Term or Phrase
ADF	Acid detergent fiber (% of DM)
ADG	Average daily weight gain (g/d)
Age1stBred	First breeding age (month)
BCS5	Body condition score (1–5 basis)
BW	Body weight (kg)
Ca	Calcium content (% of DM)
CBW	Calf birth weight (kg)
CI	Calving interval (d)
cm	centimeter
Cost	Feed cost (\$/kg of DM)
CP	Crude protein (% of DM)
d	days
DE	Digestible energy (standard value, Mcal/kg)
DIM	Days in milk
DM	Dry matter (% of as-fed basis)
DMI	Dry matter intake
DOP	Days of pregnancy (d)
dRUP	RUP degradability (% of RUP)
EE	Ether extract, in crude fat (% DM)
EndCP	Endogenous CP
EndN	Endogenous N
EQSBW	Equivalent shrunk body weight (kg)
FA	Fatty acids
FIPS	Federal Information Processing Standards
g	grams
GE	Gross energy (standard value, Mcal/kg)
GrUterW	Gravid uterine weight (kg)
Kd	Rumen protein degradation rate (%/h)
kg	kilograms
kJ	kilojoule
L	liters
m	meter
max	maximum
Mcal	Megacalorie
MCP	Microbial Crude Protein
ME	Metabolizable energy (standard value, Mcal/kg)

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Abbreviation	Full Term or Phrase
MICP	Microbial CP
min	minimum
mL	milliliters
MN	Microbial N
MP	Metabolizable protein
MTP	Microbial TP
MW	Mature body weight (kg)
MY	Milk yield
N	Nitrogen (% of DM)
NASEM	National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine
NDF	Neutral detergent fiber (% of DM)
NEG	Net energy for growth (standard value, Mcal/kg)
NEL	Net energy for lactation (standard value, Mcal/kg)
NEM	Net energy for maintenance (standard value, Mcal/kg)
nNDF	Nondigestible Neutral Detergent Fiber
NPN	Non-protein Nitrogen
NRC	National Research Council (updated in 2021 to NASEM)
OM	Organic matter (% of DM)
P	Phosphorus content (% of DM)
PAF	Processing adjustment factor (not used)
Parity	Number of lactations
PrevTemp	Average daily temperature of last month (°C)
RDP	Ruminally degraded CP
ROM	Residual OM (% of DM)
RUP	Ruminally undegraded CP
s	seconds
TAN	Total ammoniacal N
TDN	Total digestible nutrient (% of DM)
TP	True protein (% of DM)
USDA	United States Department of Agriculture
UterW	Uterine weight (kg)
WSC	Water Soluble Carbohydrates



XIV. References

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